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OUR OFFERINGS

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^{^^}Mutual Fund investments and investment in securities market are subject to market risks, read all scheme/related documents carefully.
[^]Distributed by Ujjivan Small Finance Bank Ltd. — AMFI Registered Mutual Fund Distributor (ARN: 175676).
^{*}Demat and Trading Account offered through SMC Global Securities Ltd. T&C Apply.
^{**}Loan amounts starting at ₹6,000 to over ₹250 crore are available across distinct product categories. Eligibility criteria, loan amount, applicable interest rates and other terms vary by product. T&C Apply.
[#]Interest rates are subject to change. T&C Apply.

Data as of June 30, 2026.



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INFANT DEATHS Telangana hospital fire toll rises to 5

SOUTH » PAGE 5



SUPER EL NIÑO 'India could see 15,800 heat deaths in 6 months'

NEWS » PAGE 10



ALLEGED TRESPASSING 4 A.P. students die after being run over by train

SOUTH » PAGE 5



NAVIGATING RIVALRIES *A plausible multilateralism* The BRICS offers India a space to pursue strategic autonomy

EDITORIAL » PAGE 6



MISSION ACCOMPLISHED Mirabai fulfils her Asian Games dream

SPORT » PAGE 15

NEARBY



Chief Minister inspects TNPDC headquarter

CHENNAI
Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday conducted a surprise inspection at the Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited (TNPDC) headquarter in Chennai to review various aspects of power generation and grid management. » PAGE 4



'TVK govt. failed to take steps against dengue'

CHENNAI
AIADMK chief Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Wednesday slammed the TVK-led government for not having taken steps to curb the spread of dengue. He also condemned the absence of Health Minister K.G. Arunraj at a review meeting taken by the Director of Public Health » PAGE 4

METROPLUS » 4 PAGES

Opposition calls for CEC's exit over 'illegal conduct'

Gyanesh Kumar under fire after expose on several objections by fellow Election Commissioners; Congress calls for SC-monitored probe; INDIA bloc to meet soon to discuss the issue, says Mamata

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Opposition parties on Wednesday sought the removal of Gyanesh Kumar as the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) after an *Indian Express* expose claimed that two of the three members of the Election Commission (EC), Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi, had formally recorded objections at least 14 times over the last 10 months. The two commissioners said major decisions were being made in the name of the full EC without their knowledge, several of which they called "unauthorised and illegal".

Declaring that "vote chori" is a crime against the Indian people and a direct attack on the Constitution, the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, said that "the BJP, RSS, and EC who organised it have committed an act of treason. Justice will be served."

Under the 2023 law governing the EC, all decisions should be made unanimously where possible. Where the CEC and the commissioners disagree,

Under scanner

The allegations against the CEC come amid widespread complaints about the SIR exercises and apprehensions about the poll body's conduct

KEY ISSUES RAISED

- Centralisation of electoral database
- Alteration of Form 6
- Authorisation of appeals against voter inclusion
- 97 eligible voters from Goa being left out of the roll



Sukhbir Singh Sandhu
Election Commissioner



Gyanesh Kumar
Chief Election Commissioner



Vivek Joshi
Election Commissioner



All official orders, decisions, and administrative directions issued by the commission carry full legal sanctions - EC STATEMENT

Vote chori is a crime... The BJP, RSS, and EC who organised it have committed an act of treason. Justice will be served



RAHUL GANDHI,
LoP in Lok Sabha

the majority should prevail, the law says. According to the *Indian Express* report, the two commissioners red-flagged several issues, led by the centralisation of the database of electoral rolls. In May, Mr. Joshi had reportedly proposed an audit to certify that "no one except the concerned statutory authorities has any credentials to make any change in the data base".

Opposition parties asked the Supreme Court to take *suo motu* cognizance of the report and Congress leader K.C. Venugopal demanded a Supreme Court-monitored

probe to "expose the rot that has destroyed the EC's credibility". The CEC has no right to remain in office after the expose, he said.

Former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee said the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance would meet soon to discuss the next course of action, including a *jono jagaran* (public awareness) campaign against "the BJP and its machinery". She also called for re-elections in West Bengal, Bihar, Haryana, and Madhya Pradesh, saying that the BJP had not won in these States, but rather the mandate had

been "stolen".

The EC responded on Wednesday, saying that all its actions have been in accordance with the relevant laws. Highlighting specific internal notes spread over a 10-month period while overlooking the larger body of approvals, instructions, and initiatives gives only "one part of the picture", it said.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 8

EDITORIAL

PAGE 6

SIR IS ILLEGAL: FORMER CEC

PAGE 9

MORE REPORTS ON

PAGES 4 & 8

'Minister in a panel to select CEC sends wrong signal'

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Supreme Court Justice Dipankar Datta on Wednesday said the replacement of the Chief Justice of India with a Union Cabinet Minister-led selection panel for Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and Election Commissioners *prima facie* amounts to an effective veto in favour of the Union government and fails the "perception test", sending wrong signals to the public.

The observations came in a separate opinion following a split judgment over the question whether a challenge to provisions of the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service, and Term of Office) Act of 2023 ought to be referred to a Constitution Bench or not. While Justice Datta did not find a reference to a Constitution Bench necessary, Justice Satish Chandra Sharma, the *puisse* judge on the Division Bench, held in favour of sending the case to a Constitution Bench, reasoning that several questions of substantial importance were at stake.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 8

India, EU to sign trade deal on December 16

Final touches

Negotiations on the India-EU Free Trade Agreement, dubbed the 'mother of all deals', were concluded in January 2026

The FTA will see the EU dropping tariffs on **99.5%** of Indian exports to the region, with most tariffs going down to **0%**

India will give tariff concessions on **97.5%** of the traded value between the two economies



T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI

The Free Trade Agreement (FTA) between India and the European Union (EU) will be signed on December 16, two diplomatic sources have separately confirmed to *The Hindu*.

This will be part of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's back-to-back trips in December to Canada, the U.S., and Belgium, where three separate FTAs are currently either being negotiated or in the process of approval.

Further, as the EU FTA has received "majority approval" in Europe, it will not require separate ratification by each EU country once the European Council gives its go-ahead.

The next step, after the signing, will be passage in the European Parliament, which will take another one to two months, paving the way for a roll-out in "early 2027".

"The most recent development was the European Commission finalising the text of the deal and sending it to the European Council," a diplomatic source told *The Hindu*.

"The signing is scheduled for December 16, after which it will go to the European Parliament."

Negotiations on the India-EU FTA, dubbed the "mother of all deals" by leaders on both sides, restarted in June 2022 after a long hiatus and were concluded in January this year.

The deal would see the EU dropping tariffs on 99.5% of items India exports to the region, with most tariffs going down to 0% immediately once the agreement comes into effect.

India, on the other hand, has given tariff concessions on 97.5% of the traded value between the two economies.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 8

T.N. Congress leader claims he told Chennai police about Veeramani scandal 2 years ago

EXCLUSIVE

Udhav Naig
CHENNAI

In a twist to the sensational child sexual abuse case allegedly involving Gem Granites owner R. Veeramani, a Congress leader on Wednesday said he had informed the Chennai police about the crime as early as in November 2024.

The following month, he had also shared with the police a video clip in which a man resembling the octogenarian business magnate was seen abusing a minor girl.

"I met a senior police officer at the Chennai Police Commissionerate in Egmore on November 22, 2024, and submitted a written complaint (dated November 21), seeking action against Veeramani and his associate Shanthi (both now in custody). I also attached screenshots from the video clip," M.P. Ranjan Kumar, president, Tamil Nadu Congress Committee's Scheduled Caste Department, said.

He shared with *The Hindu* a copy of the complaint, which he claimed he had handed over to the senior police officer, as well as screenshots of his conver-



R. Veeramani

sation with the officer on WhatsApp, seeking his appointment to discuss the issue.

Mr. Kumar's claim contradicts the Chennai police's statement that they had received a complaint and a pen drive of the video of the sexual abuse through an NGO only in October last year.

"The senior officer assured me that action would be taken after conferring with the then Police Commissioner. On November 25, 2024, an Inspector from the Anti-Vice Squad sought information related to the case. On December 17, 2024, I sent him (Inspector) the video clip. Thereafter, I was repeatedly asked if I knew the victims seen in the video. I did not know them, but I insisted that if the police could summon Veeramani and

Shanthi or conduct a surprise raid at their homes, they would be able to retrieve more evidence," he said. Mr. Kumar alleged that the police, however, gradually stopped correspondence with him on the case.

The Congress leader said he was disclosing this as some vested interests were seeking to link him with the scandal, and the police, too, had not acknowledged his role and were now seeking to push back the case by a year, claiming they had received a complaint only last year.

In his complaint, Mr. Kumar had alleged: "Gem Granites proprietor, Veeramani, had been frequenting the residence of Shanthi and had been preying on girl children aged between 14 and 16, particularly belonging to oppressed and minority communities. I had been given the possession of videos that show sexual acts performed by him on girl children..."

He had lodged the complaint "in the hope that the children would be protected".

CONTINUED ON

PAGE 4

SEARCHES AT FIVE PLACES

PAGE 4

SIT to investigate graft claims against Pinarayi

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Keralam government has constituted a special investigation team (SIT) to probe the corruption allegations against Leader of the Opposition and former Chief Minister, Pinarayi Vijayan; his daughter T. Vee-na; and son-in-law and former Minister P.A. Mohamed Riyas, and others in the CMRL-Exalogic pay-off case.

The probe will be supervised by Addi-



FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 5

We are 'terror victims', Pezeshkian tells UN

Associated Press
UNITED NATIONS

Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian said on Wednesday that his people have been "victims of terrorism" by the United States, delivering a rare wartime speech at UN General Assembly a day after U.S. President Donald Trump said he could "annihilate" the

Islamic republic.

In a defiant speech, Mr. Pezeshkian held up large photos of the late Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei and the more than 150 Iranian school children killed by U.S. strikes on the first days of the war. He also asserted that Tehran did not hit "civilian populations" during the ongoing war.



FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 14

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INBRIEF



CM congratulates badminton team after bronze medal win

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday congratulated the Indian men's badminton team for winning a bronze medal at the Asian Games being held in Japan. The Chief Minister also congratulated Hariharan, who was part of the team, from Tamil Nadu. In recognition of his achievement, the Tamil Nadu government would provide Mr. Hariharan with a cash incentive of ₹30 lakh. Mr. Hariharan, who has been receiving financial assistance under the Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu's 'ELITE sportsperson scheme', had achieved a feat that would serve as a great inspiration to the youth of Tamil Nadu. The Tamil Nadu government will always stand by the dreams of sportspersons, Mr. Vijay said in a post on the social media platform X.

Traffic police withdraw U-turn restrictions on OMR as trial triggers severe congestion

As per the announcement, vehicles heading to Sholinganallur from Mettukuppam were told to take U-turn at Perungudi toll booth instead of the one near Geetham restaurant. Three other U-turns were also introduced. Further changes will be made only after studying traffic flow, says a GCTP officer

STORIES FROM THE ROAD

Deepa H. Ramakrishnan
R. Sivaraman
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Traffic Police (GCTP) withdrew a U-turn trial on OMR after it resulted in heavy traffic on Wednesday. Intended to streamline traffic around the Thoraipakkam-Perungudi stretch, the experiment turned into a nightmare for commuters. Following the GCTP's implementation of new U-turn restrictions in connection with the ongoing Metro Rail and road align-

ment works, traffic slowed to a crawl on OMR. The traffic changes were implemented with effect from Wednesday to reduce congestion and regulate vehicular movement on Rajiv Gandhi Salai (OMR) and in the Thoraipakkam area. As per the announcement, vehicles proceeding towards Sholinganallur from Mettukuppam and Pillayar Kovil Street were prohibited from making a U-turn near Geetham restaurant. They were told to take the U-turn at the Perungudi toll booth instead. The traffic police also introduced three more U-turns on OMR. Commuters said the U-

turns that were previously located roughly one km away had been pushed significantly farther, which, coupled with traffic congestion, has caused severe inconvenience to many office-goers. Hussain, a resident of PTC Quarters, said he was unable to cross the service lane to reach a medical shop on the other side of the road in the morning. "It usually takes me about five minutes to cross the road, but today, I was unable to navigate the traffic, and it took me half an hour to reach the shop," he said. Vaishnaves Suresh, a resident of Thoraipakkam, said, "When I left home by 9.45 a.m., Google Maps

showed it would take 29 minutes just to reach Perungudi. There were few policemen on the road. I saw ambulances trying to get vehicles to give way, their sirens blaring. The main road and the service lane on the Sholinganallur-Thiruvannmiur stretch were packed with slow-moving vehicles." The congestion eased in the afternoon after the traffic police withdrew the changes. A senior officer of the GCTP said they withdrew the changes that were introduced on a trial basis following traffic congestion. "We may reintroduce it only after studying the traffic flow and other factors," the officer said.



At a crawl: The U-turns were meant to reduce traffic congestion in areas surrounding the Thoraipakkam-Perungudi stretch.

2 held in separate cases of cheating, misappropriation

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tambaram Central Crime Branch (CCB) has arrested two persons accused in separate cases of cheating and misappropriation involving a total amount of ₹4.63 crore. Based on a complaint lodged by Theneeswari, the first case was registered at the CCB on June 10. The complainant alleged that she was induced to invest ₹95,000 in Globes Group Digital Private Limited on false promises of employment, partnership,

and substantial profits. She was also lured into making additional investments and enrolling other persons on the assurance of profits and repayment through a digital wallet facility. During investigation, it was revealed that Babu Iyappan, the alleged main accused, had induced more than 135 persons and collected over ₹4 crore through 27 persons by making false promises. Babu Iyappan, a native of Tiruvannamalai, was arrested on Monday. He was produced before the Alan-

dur Judicial Magistrate Court, and lodged in Central Prison, Puzhal. Laptops, mobile phones, cash, and other articles were also seized from him. Diversion of ₹63 lakh In the second case, Gopalakrishnan, proprietor of M/s. Pioneer Agencies, Pammal, lodged a complaint alleging that Ilanchezhian, alias Subash, who was working as the in-charge of the company's Pammal branch, diverted payments received from retailers and broiler chicken shop owners to his per-

sonal bank account. The accused allegedly replaced the company's GPay QR code with his own, thereby misappropriating approximately ₹63 lakh. The case was initially registered at the Shankar Nagar police station. Pursuant to the orders of the Madras High Court, it was transferred to the Tambaram CCB and re-registered on August 29. During investigation, relevant documents and financial records were collected, and the diversion of payments through the ac-

cused's personal QR code was established. Ilanchezhian, alias Subash, was arrested. He was produced before the Judicial Magistrate-I, Tambaram, and remanded in judicial custody. The Tambaram City Police Commissioner Prem Anand Sinha said they would continue to take stringent action against those involved in cheating, financial fraud, and misappropriation. Further investigation is under way to identify other suspects and gather additional evidence.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 28-year-old television actor was arrested for allegedly assaulting and threatening a man, along with her associates, and extorting ₹5.5 lakh from him in Guindy on Tuesday. The complainant, Tarun, 26, stays at a hostel in Guindy and is engaged in stock trading. He told the police that his friend Varshini Venkat, the TV actor, had asked him to invest money in a short film she was making with her friends.

According to the complaint, when Tarun returned to his hostel after stepping out early on Tuesday, Varshini, Sanjay, and two others demanded money from him. When he refused, they allegedly picked a quarrel with him and assaulted him. He then handed over ₹50,000 to them. Later, Sanjay allegedly contacted him over the phone and threatened him, following which Tarun transferred ₹3 lakh to Varshini's bank account and ₹2 lakh to Sanjay's. He told the police that

even after he paid ₹5.5 lakh in total, Sanjay demanded another ₹27 lakh from him. Based on Tarun's complaint, the Guindy police registered a case and launched an investigation. They examined Tarun's bank transactions and confirmed that money had been transferred to Varshini's account. They arrested Varshini and seized an iPhone from her. She was produced before a court after interrogation and remanded in judicial custody. Efforts are under way to trace the other accused.

CINEMA ARTS EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

Arulmigu Sri Kapaleeswarar Temple, Mylapore, Chennai. Today (24.09.2026) Thursday 6.45 PM - onwards Pradosham Special 'NAMASANKER-THANAM' by Smt.Sivasri Skandaprasad. Accompanying Artist - N.Chandrasekhar - Harmonium, Jaidav Harijoss - Mridangam, Sankaranarayanan - Dokki. All are welcome

Naada Inbam, 24992672 Ramanathapuram Shri M N Kandaswamy Pillai Centenary program 'A Garland of Javalis' by Dr Nanditha Ravi. Today 6.50pm at Ragasudha Hall.

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SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE FOR ENGINEERING WORKS

Sr. No. (1) E-Tender No.: DRM-ENGGBSP-T-170-26-27, Date: 19.09.2026.

Work: Extension/Improvement of Foot Over Bridges at Daghora and Janga Railway Stations along with other allied works, Provision of protective screens at Gevra Road and Saragaon Deori Railway Stations and miscellaneous repair works under the jurisdiction of Sr. Divisional Engineer/ East, Bilaspur Division. Tender Value: ₹ 10,34,65,744/-. Earnest Money Deposit: ₹ 20,69,300/-, Completion Period: 12 Months.

Start Date of Submission of Tender: From 29.09.2026. Last Date of Submission of Tender: Upto 11.00 hours on 13.10.2026.

The complete information of above e-Tender Notices is available over websites: <https://www.reps.gov.in> Bids other than e-bids shall not be accepted against above Tender.

Divisional Railway Manager(Engg) CPR/10/PH/413 Bilaspur.

f South East Central Railway X @secrail

TAMIL NADU HOUSING BOARD
ERODE HOUSING UNIT
ANNOUNCEMENT

To sale the Unsold commercial plots, shops, and public purpose sites in various schemes of Erode Housing Unit through e-tender cum e-auction, the Applications were previously invited through <https://tntenders.gov.in> web portal for the period from 25.08.2026 to 24.09.2026. Now the timeline for this has been extended by another 15 days.

Executive Engineer and Administrative Officer, Erode Housing Unit

DIPR/ 832 /DISPLAY/2026

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Letter No: 854 Date Extension Notice-05 Date: 23/09/2026

Due to unavoidable circumstances, due dates in respect of online Bid Identification No.T-01/EE(Solar)/2026-27 are revised as follows:
Last Date/Time of Receipt of bid on the portal: 30-09-2026 upto 16:00 Hrs.
Last Date/Time of submission of bid in Office: 03-10-2026 upto 12:00 Hrs.
Date of opening of the bid on website: 03-10-2026 from 13:00 Hrs.
All other details and terms & conditions shall remain same. Detail of subsequent addendum/corrigendum/cancellation etc. may be obtained from the website.
Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in>

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TENDER NOTICE

APPCO on behalf of the APDISCOMs inviting bids in single stage, two enveloped followed by e-RA through Bharat Electronic e-Tendering Portal vide Tender No: APPCC/PSP-01/2026-27 for Procurement of 500 MW Energy Storage Capacity (8 hours per day, with a maximum of 6 hours continuous discharge) from Pumped Storage Projects fully commissioned or part-commissioned with untied capacity in anywhere in India through Competitive Bidding for a period of 5 years extendable for another period of 2 years with input power from APDISCOMs. The interested and eligible applicants may participate in the bidding process through the ISN-ETS portal Date & availability of RFS document in Bharat Electronic e-Tendering Portal is after 24.09.2026 at 17:00 hrs. The due date for submission of bids is 12.10.2026. For complete details and tender access visit: <https://www.bharat-electronictender.com>; Ph: 9493120085

Sd/- Chief General Manager/APPCO Power Purchase & Legal

R.O. No. GMCC/APTRANSCO/156/26-27

S. E. RAILWAY - TENDER

For on behalf of President of India, the General Manager (Engg.), South Eastern Railway, Garden Reach Kolkata-700043 invites e-tender for the following works:

Tender Notice No. SER/HQ/Engg/PSC Slab-26-27/ Dated 22.09.2026

Description of the work:- Casting of PSC slabs from 3.05 m to 12.2 m and ballast retainers as per approved drawings and development of PSC slab casting yard at Engineering workshop SINI in connection with Strengthening/Rehabilitation/Reconstruction/Re-girdering of existing bridges for running of 25T axle load in SER to achieve 3000MT mission..

Tender Value (Rs.): - 86,41,88,573.40, Earnest Money (Rs.): - 1,72,83,800.00, Tender Document Cost (Rs.): - Nil, Tender Closing Date Time:- 26.10.2026 15:30 hrs., Period of Completion:- 24 (Twenty Four) Months., Interested Tenderer's may visit website www.reps.gov.in for full details/ description of the tenders and to know the status of this tender so as to submit their bids online. Physical/manual tender for this work will not be accepted. (PR -800)

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(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru-560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-DPR-04/1630/2026-27 Date: 22.09.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

KIADB invites tenders from reputed consultants/firms under two cover bid system having an office at Bengaluru with vast experience and proven record of similar nature of work for project mentioned below:-

Name of the Works: Providing Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for the Formation of New Industrial Area Including Economic Analysis, Surveying, Layout Plan Design, Preparation of Cost Estimates, Cost Structure etc., for the Proposed Balakunji Industrial Area, Udupi Taluk & District in an extent of Extent 316.79 acres

The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **07.10.2026 upto 4.00 pm.**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>.

Sd/- Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/2857/SMCL/2026-27

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Applications are invited from dynamic, experienced, passionate candidates with IT skills and growth mindset to apply for the following expected vacancies for the Academic Year 2027-2028 w.e.first week of April 2027

- Passionate, forward-thinking educators with strong 21st-century teaching skills & a student-centred approach are invited to apply. •Qualifications must be from recognised institutions through regular mode, with English as the medium of instruction. •Excellent spoken & written English, communication & interpersonal skills are essential. •Minimum 3 years of CBSE teaching experience preferred. •Candidates below 45 years preferred, with proficiency in technology-enabled teaching, innovative pedagogy & contemporary educational practices.

Kindly visit the website for further information regarding the vacancies: https://indianschoolsalalah.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/09/ISS_RECRUITMENT_VACANCIES_Wp-2027-2028.pdf
Last Date for submission of the application: 7th Oct. 2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given that our clients are in the process of purchasing the below-referred rights for multiple telecasts of the below-referred films (Films), for the period detailed in the schedule hereinafter.

To the best of our knowledge and belief, the Film is free from any encumbrances, claims or demands, whatsoever. However, should any person(s) have claim against, to, or in respect of the Film, whether by way of any sale, lease, assignment, licence, pledge, gift, mortgage, charge, sale, litigation, and/or transfer of any kind whatsoever or otherwise, such person(s) are hereby required to make the same known in writing along with documentary proof/evidence (certified true copies) of the aforesaid claim to the undersigned at the address given below, within 7 (seven) days from the date of publication hereof, failing which the transaction will be completed without reference to such claims and the claims, if any, will be deemed to have been waived. Claims without any documentary proof and/or any claims received after the expiry of the stipulated 7 (seven) days shall not be entertained.

SCHEDULE

Title of the Film : RIGHT	
Language(s) : Tamil	
Star Cast : Natty Subramaniam, Arun Pandian, Akshara Reddy & Others	
Director : Subramaniam Ramesh	
Effective Date : Immediately upon delivery of the materials and QC clearance	
End Date : Perpetual	
Territory : Entire World (Exclusive for India territories and non-exclusive for rest of the world)	
Runs : Unlimited	
Rights : (i) Shall mean the Linear (i) Satellite Broadcasting rights; (ii) Cable TV Rights; (iii) Terrestrial Rights; (iv) Doordarshan Rights; (v) DTH Rights; (vi) IPTV Rights; (vii) Simulcast Rights; (viii) Subtitling Rights in English & Tamil; (ix) Digital Terrestrial Television (DTT); (x) Syndication Rights in India; (xi) Ancillary Rights; (xii) Clip Rights; (xiii) Catch up TV Rights; (xiv) Direct-to - Mobile Rights and (xv) New Exploitation Rights & Methods.	
Dated : 24th September 2026	Sd/-
Place : Chennai	1206-1208, 12th Floor, Elite Business Park, In the lane of Shagun Hava rights, Next to Prajapati Bhavan, Near Kargil Petrol Pump, Sola, Ahmedabad, Gujarat- 380 060.
	Nanavati & Co Advocates

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INBRIEF



Centre to receive complaints from hostel students opened

Minister for Social Justice Vanni Arasu on Wednesday launched a round-the-clock control centre meant to take up the grievances of students residing in social justice hostels across the State. The control centre would function on the premises of the Directorate of Adi Dravidar Welfare at Ezhilagam in Chennai. It would take up complaints related to food and accommodation submitted through the mobile number +91 73388 01456 and the social media page of the Adi Dravidar Welfare Directorate. The Minister and the Secretary of the Social Justice Department would be apprised of the status of the grievances every week. During the launch, the Minister also interacted through videoconference with students residing in social justice hostels regarding the facilities available to them. Social Justice Department Secretary N. Subbaiyan; Director, Adi Dravidar Welfare, K. Senthilraj; and Director, Tribal Welfare, S. Annadurai, were among those who were present at the launch.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper. thehindu.com) carries explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (September 24, Thursday), the following articles are available:

- How are road accident claims decided? newsth.live/roadaccidentclaims
- As AI marches on math research, scholars ponder the future newsth.live/aicalculations

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

260 persons sent to judicial custody after special drive

CHENNAI: The State police checked on 9,329 history-sheeters during a two-day special drive against anti-social elements across the State. A total of 260 of them have been remanded in judicial custody. The special drive was conducted on September 21 and September 22 on the instructions of Director-General of Police and Head of Police Force Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal, as part of preventive measures to maintain law and order.

Timings	
CHENNAI	
THURSDAY, SEP. 24	
RISE 05:58	SET 18:04
RISE 16:28	SET 03:44
FRIDAY, SEP. 25	
RISE 05:58	SET 18:03
RISE 17:07	SET 04:34
SATURDAY, SEP. 26	
RISE 05:58	SET 18:03
RISE 17:45	SET 05:24

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	34	24
Chennai Airport	34	24
Chennai City	34	25

Chennai Airport Today 35°C The weather will be warm and windy. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light rain and thundershower may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow 36°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be very warm. Night also will be comfortable. Dry weather to occur.

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Land Ports Authority of India, MHA

(Appointment of Member (Planning & Development) on deputation basis)

MHA had issued a vacancy circular dated 24th April, 2026 for filling up the post of Member (Planning & Development) with the last date of submission of applications being 23-05-2026. Now the last date is being extended up to 30-09-2026. For more details, please visit the website of Ministry of Home Affairs at <http://mha.gov.in> and LPAI at <http://lpai.gov.in>.

CBC 19142/11/0014/2627

Airports Authority of India to make detailed plans for T5 Terminal at city airport

A review meeting was held between the State government and the AAI last week to discuss the construction of the T5 Terminal and the elevated corridor, and ways to boost airport's capacity

PORT CALL

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Airports Authority of India (AAI) will soon start chalking out plans to build the T5 Terminal at Chennai airport and the elevated corridor to provide access to passengers.

A review meeting was held recently between the Tamil Nadu government and the AAI last week to discuss the construction of the T5 Terminal and the corridor, and ways to enhance capacity of the airport.

As the State government has scrapped the Parandur airport project and wanted to pursue the expansion of the existing airport before a new site is identified for the second airport in city, this review meeting was held, sources said.

This is the second review meeting being held between the State government and the AAI to discuss the means to improve the airport and the expansion plans.

The T5 Terminal will be situated in the airside of the airport and hence to create an entry for passen-

At present, only a basic framework for the Terminal and the access road is ready

gers from the city side, an elevated corridor has been proposed from NH 32 (near Madha Engineering College). This is likely to be a six-lane corridor.

At present, only a skeletal framework for the T5 Terminal and the access road is ready and a detailed plan needs to be drafted.

“We are discussing the area which has to be ear-



Expansive project: A source said that it may take seven to eight years to build the T5 terminal and the elevated corridor that will come up as part of the project. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

marked for the terminal and how to establish the access for the terminal. This is in a nascent stage now. Full-fledged planning will begin shortly,” an official said.

There were discussions about the number of aircraft movements handled per hour and why it has not increased.

AAI was asked to take a relook at how much the capacity – in terms of aircraft movement and passenger traffic – can increase if the expansion work is carried out.

“It may take nearly 7-8 years to finish the planning

and build this terminal and elevated corridor. The State may as well place its focus on the second airport instead of this expansion,” another source said.

Airlines too have pushed the government to decrease the value added tax (VAT) in the Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF). The State government, on the other hand, has asked the airlines to bring in more connectivity from Chennai airport. But it is to be noted that adding connectivity from an airport gets decided between an airline and the Ministry of Civil Aviation.

Court sentences man to 15 years in prison for abducting minor girl

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A special court in Tiruvallur on Wednesday sentenced a 22-year-old man to a total of 15 years for abducting a 15-year-old girl after allegedly promising to

marry her. The accused, Ranjith Kumar, 22, allegedly took the girl away on February 25, 2024.

Following a complaint from the girl's mother, the Ambattur All Women Police Station registered a case, conducted the inves-

tigation, and filed a charge sheet. The case came up for trial before the Special Court for POCSO Cases in Tiruvallur. The court found the accused guilty and sentenced him to 15 years' rigorous imprisonment and imposed a fine of ₹10,000.

THE HINDU

DISCLAIMER: Readers are requested to verify and make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THE PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

Tamil Nadu Power Generation Corporation Ltd

Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
84	SE/MM-H/ NCTPS-I	Unit I Providing cup lock metallic scaffolding arrangements inside the boiler furnace
1003	CE/TMPS-II	Procurement of Sulphuric Acid 98 percent 460 MT

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit websites: www.tangedco.gov.in, www.tenders.gov.in, www.dipr.org.in

DIPR/2932/Tender/2026

STATE INDUSTRIES PROMOTION CORPORATION OF TAMIL NADU LIMITED

19-A, RUKMANI LAKSHMPATHY ROAD, EGMORE, CHENNAI-600 008.

CIN U74999TN1971SGC005967

(ONLINE ONLY)

Tender Notice NIT.No.31/CD/TO.No.31/2026-27 Date: 23.09.2026

For and on behalf of State Industries Promotion Corporation of Tamil Nadu Limited, sealed tenders are invited under “Single Cover System” through online for the following work from reputed firms having experience in similar nature of works. The Programme for the issue, receipt and opening of bids would be as under. Tenders will be received upto 15.30 Hrs (as per server system clock) on 15.10.2026 and the same will be opened at 15.30 Hrs (as per server system clock) on 16.10.2026.

Name of Work	Approx. value of work	EMD
Operation and Maintenance of Green parking at SIPCOT IT Park Sriurani for a period of 36 months (three years) (Per year rate).	Rs.13.74 lakhs (including GST @18%)	Rs.14,000/-

* EMD should be paid through Online in the portal (<https://ntenders.gov.in>)

The tender Schedule can be Downloaded at free of cost from the website <https://ntenders.gov.in>

DIPR/2929/Tender/2026

SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER

TIRUNELVELI CORPORATION

General Fund

E-TENDER NOTICE 11/2026-27/RFP

1	Tender Inviting Authority Designation, Address	Commissioner, Municipal Corporation, Tirunelveli.
2	Name of Work:	Description Selection of Consultants for Preparation of Detailed Project Report for Pedestrian Friendly Street Projects : Safe Access to Schools, Complete Streets and Junction Improvements in Tirunelveli City Municipal Corporation
3	Web site Address	https://ntenders.gov.in (Tender document available from the above web site at free of cost)
4	Date and Time for the Bid document available	From 25.09.2026, 10.00 Am To 24.11.2026, 3.00PM
5	Due date and time for submission of bids	From 25.09.2026, 10.00 Am To 24.11.2026, 3.00PM
6	Place, Date and time of opening of bids	Tirunelveli Corporation main office 24.11.2026 at 3.30 pm
7	Pre bid Meeting Date and Time	22.10.2026 at 11.00 AM

DIPR/2914/TENDER/2026

Commissioner, Tirunelveli Corporation.

REPLACEMENT OF LOW INSULATION/ DEFECTIVE SIGNALING CABLES

E-Tender No.: SNT-10-LMG-2026-27-RT; Date: 17-09-2026. E-tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following work. Name of work: Replacement of Low Insulation/defective Signaling cables under the jurisdiction of Sr. DS/TE/Lumding. Tender Value: ₹1,66,28,496.05. Bid Security: ₹3,32,600.00. E-tender will be Closed at 15.00 hrs. on 09-10-2026 and Opened at 15.30 hrs. on 09-10-2026. For details visit: www.ireps.gov.in

Sr. DS/TE, Lumding

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(“Navratna” - Government of India Enterprise)

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Corporate Office: Block-A, Newell - 601 801, Gudalore District, Tamil Nadu.

CIN: L33909TN1956G01003507, Website: www.nlcindia.in

Advt.No:10/2026

RECRUITMENT OF GRADUATE EXECUTIVE TRAINEES THROUGH GATE - 2025 SCORES

NLC India Limited (NLCIL), a “NAV RATNA” Public Sector Enterprise under the administrative control of Ministry of Coal is spreading its wings in the frontiers of Mining (Lignite & Coal), Thermal Power generation and Renewable energy.

NLCIL intends to recruit Graduate Executive Trainees (Engineering Graduates) on the basis of GATE-2025 scores in following technical disciplines.

Discipline	AREA 1 Thermal Power Station	AREA 2 Mines & Allied Services	AREA 3 Renewable Energy Planning & Projects	AREA 4 Services & Support	Total
Mechanical	40	20	06	-	66
Electrical	30	05	05	04	44
Civil	10	02	07	04	23
Mining	-	10	-	-	10
Computer	-	-	02	-	02
Total	80	37	20	8	145

Detailed Advertisement indicating the number of vacancies in each discipline, qualification requirements, reservation of posts and other terms & conditions including modalities for registration & the dates for opening & closure of Online Application Portal etc. will be hosted in Careers page of NLC India Limited Website (www.nlcindia.in) and eligible candidates may apply online through the same.

PUBLIC SECTOR IS YOURS : HELP IT TO HELP YOU

BENGALURU METROPOLITAN TRANSPORT CORPORATION

Traffic Commercial Department, 2nd Floor, Shanthinagar TMC, K.H. Road, Shanthinagar, Bengaluru-560 027.

No: BMTCCO/TR/COM/1959/2007/2026-27 Date: 23.09.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION No: 24/2026-27 (Through e-Procurement Platform)

Bengaluru Metropolitan Transport Corporation invites bids from eligible persons/agencies for the establishment, operation, and maintenance of Smart Parking Facilities on Revenue Sharing Model at Shanthinagar T.T.M.C MLCIP and Kalasipalya Bus Station parking locations through the e-procurement platform.

Pre-Bid meeting date & time	30.09.2026 at 11:30 am	Place: CTM(C)'s Chamber, 2nd Floor, Central Office, BMTCC, Shanthinagar, Bengaluru-27.
Last date & time for submission of bids is on	27.10.2026 up to 17:00 hrs.	
Opening of Technical bids is on	28.10.2026 at 17:05 hrs.	
Opening of Financial bids is on	To be Intimated later	

Further, EMD amount, measurement and all other necessary details in this regard can be obtained in the e-procurement portal www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in or by Contacting: 09240214000, 09240214001, 080-22483777 & 7760991222 or E-mail: ctmc@mybmtc.com.

Sd/- Chief Traffic Manager (Com) (Tender Inviting Authority)

WESTERN RAILWAY

MATERIAL MANAGEMENT DEPARTMENT

VARIOUS MATERIALS SUPPLY

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE No. S/56/2026 Date 21.09.2026

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Short Description	Quantity	T.O.D.
442	23255020A	Supply of CASNUB 22HS Bogie for BOXNHL Wagons	20 Nos	9-Nov-26
443	15262075A	Gang Way Bridge Mounting Assembly	671 Nos	5-Nov-26
444	15260503	Rear cover for axle box to ICF Drg. No. T-0-2-603, Alt. G/14, Item No. 2, alternatively pressure die casting is acceptable	5495 Nos	3-Nov-26
445	23261940	Secondary spring out for generator car	130 Nos	26-Oct-26
446	23262221	Bearing Piece Assembly	23281 Nos	22-Oct-26
447	27268162	Rate Contract for Spares of Plasser Make Track Machines for period of two years (2027-2028 & 2028-2029)	1 Set	19-Oct-26
448	27265005A	Various Item of Tungsten Carbide Tamping Tools (TCTT)	41 Set	19-Oct-26
449	04263681	Soft Blanket	24126 Nos	19-Oct-26

Regarding detailed notice EMD, Purchase restrictions and detailed tender conditions, please visit website www.ireps.gov.in and www.indianrailways.gov.in

0623

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Encroached area: Street vendors occupy the designated sit-out spaces along the Besant Nagar beach, leaving little room for passers-by to occupy the seating area. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

Stalls leave little space for pedestrians at Besant Nagar beach

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

“Decades ago, Bessy was Chennai’s cleanest beach but it is no longer the same,” says Subramaniam K.A., a resident of Besant Nagar who has been living there for 43 years.

On a Sunday evening, the beachfront along Elliot’s beach is flooded with stalls facing the road, which leaves little room for passers-by to occupy the seating area.

“Since the shops are facing the road, we are not able to sit on the long stretch of seating area. They tell us to move because apparently we are spoiling their business by sitting close to their shops. So, we have to occupy only the opposite seating area, which is also occupied by makeshift stalls, with food and accessory vendors swarming on weekends,” says Mr. Subramaniam. Commenting on the varieties of items sold at the stalls, he says that there are

at least 20 of them selling the same thing.

Some walkers also repeatedly commented that the beach becomes too dirty on weekends. Senior citizen Kanthi S., resident of Besant Nagar, says there is also dog menace. “With that, vendors and public that visit the beach also throw away wrappers and eatables. Mainly, we are not able to come to the beach for a breath of fresh air. It is fully encroached by shops and we are unable to walk in the pathway either,” adds Ms. Kanthi.

Another resident of Besant Nagar who did not wanted to be named, said there should be regular eviction drives against stalls that are functioning without licenses and food safety clearances.

“Some pedestrians have mentioned that there is little respite for walkers. We will look into this seriously and take action on the encroachments,” said R. Durai Raj, Ward Committee Chairman of Zone 13.

TELANGANA STATE CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION LIMITED

Regd. Office: 6-3-655/1/A, C S Bhavan, Somajiguda, Hyderabad -500 082.

NOTICE INVITING PROPOSALS

RFP Notice No.: TGSCSL/PROC/VLTs/2026/01 dated 23.09.2026

Online bids are invited from eligible and experienced Service Providers for selection of an Agency for integration of GPS devices installed on paddy-transporting vehicles with a Vehicle Location Tracking System (VLTs), enabling real-time tracking and integration with the State Procurement Portal (OPMS), on an SLA-linked per-trip basis, for a period of three (3) years from 01.10.2026 to 30.09.2029. Selection of the Service Provider shall be based on the lowest (L1) quoted Base Per-Trip Rate among the technically qualified bidders, subject to the terms and conditions stipulated in the RFP.

The detailed Request for Proposal (RFP) containing the Scope of Work, eligibility and pre-qualification criteria, SLA requirements, terms and conditions, and prescribed proformas may be downloaded from the Telangana State e-Procurement Portal: <http://tender.telangana.gov.in>

Contact: 7995050700 / 9704534627 / 9281423637 E-mail: hoproccurement.tgscsl@gmail.com

DIPR R.O.No.567/PT/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:23.09.2026 Sd/-VC & Managing Director

Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli

E-Advertised Tender Notice No. 35 ET/2026 Dated: 18.09.2026

S. N.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Due Date
01	07261773	Drilling insert for boring in Bolster pin Brackets Hole Solid cutter for machining of Bolster "L" Type metal staplers	140 Nos 32Nos	09.10.2026
02	05261335	Milling insert for Milling in Bolster pin Brackets surface	1400 Nos	16.10.2026

Corrigendum

01	Tender Notice No. 30 ET/2026 Dated:25.08.2026	Tender No. 03261070	Due date may be read as 07/10/2026 Instead of 22/09/2026	Pre-Bid Conference date & time 25.09.2026 AM:11:30
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Website Address: www.ireps.gov.in & www.mcf.indianrailways.gov.in Dy.CMM/Electrical

Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli

E-Advertised Tender Notice No. 36 ET/2026 Dated: 22.09.2026

S. N.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Due Date
01	05261212A	110V,120AH VRLA SMF Battery Set With 19 Monoblock (8V EACH)	379 Set	12.10.2026
02	05261354	Valve Regulated Lead Acid Batteries 120AH Capacity	201Set	20.10.2026
03	03261727	Entrance Hand Rail Complete	9980Nos	23.10.2026
04	04261312	SET of Doorway Partition for Memu TC 3 PHASE Coaches	603 Set	28.10.2026
		Set of Doorway Partition for MEMU/DMC/ 3PH coaches.	201 Set	
05	03261620	Design, Supply and Installation of Partition Frames, Interior Doors, NONAC Area Panelling and Linen Room Arrangement for LWACCN/PP2 Coaches	72 Set	23.10.2026
		Design, Supply and Installation of Partition Frames, Interior Doors, NONAC Area Panelling and Linen Room Arrangement for LWACCN/PP2 Coaches	24 Set	
06	15265289	Design, Development, Supply, installation, commissioning and proving out of universal Shell Jig for manufacturing of MEMU & Vande Bharat coaches	2 Nos.	16.10.2026
07	07261900	Extra High Purity Nitrogen GAS TO BE Supplied IN Packs of 16 Cylinders.	117569 CUM	05.11.2026
08	15265290	Supply, Installation and Commissioning and Proving out of High Rise Platform for Vande Bharat Train set	5 Nos	14.10.2026
09	07261925	Chopped Strand Mat	48990Kgs	22.10.2026
10	03261393A	Supply of one set of Nosecone coupler Cover for Train Set	51 Set	27.10.2026

Website Address: www.ireps.gov.in & www.mcf.indianrailways.gov.in Dy.CMM/Electrical

Open tender based on Single packet system Tender Notice No. - MCF-RBL-SPRINKLER-110-01 Dt. 19.09.2026 is invited by Dr. Chief Mechanical Engineer/Safety & Training, MCF/RBL through IREPS portal www.ireps.gov.in for and on behalf of president of India for the following work:-

Description of work : "Supply, Installation and commissioning of automatic water sprinkler, smoke detector & beam detector in Furnishing store-I, Furnishing store-II, General Store, PDC and New shell store-II and Hiring of multipurpose Fire Tender in factory area for 03 years (36 months) as per scope of work at Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli. Approx. Value (₹) : ₹ 7,11,90,979.70. Cost of Tender document (₹) : Nil. EMD: ₹14,23,800.00. Quantity - As per schedule of rate, Completion period of work- 36 months. Date & time of closing of Tender- 12.10.2026 up to 15.00 hrs. Detailed Tender Notice, Eligibility criteria, Terms & conditions are available at IREPS website: www.ireps.gov.in in tender documents.

Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer/Safety & Training

E-Tender Notice No. 07/2026-27 (Open) of Dy.CE/II/MCF/RBL

Deputy Chief Engineer-II/ Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli for and on behalf of President of India, invites "E-Tenders" for following works:

SN :1. Name of work: Construction of 01 Nos of Borewell in east colony for filling tanks. (Balance work estimate). Tender No.: 12-2026-27-RT. Approx cost: ₹91,79,643.51. Date of Opening of Tender: 22.10.2026. Completion Period: 12 Months. Tenderer/s shall be able to submit their original/revised bids up to closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed for this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. For detail, please log on Indian Railways IREPS website www.ireps.gov.in.

Dy. Chief Engineer/II

SERVICE CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

From Page One

Cong. leader says he told Chennai police about Veeramani 2 years ago

When asked how he got hold of the video, Mr. Kumar claimed that Shanthi, with whom he was acquainted in the course of real estate business, had in August 2024 sought his help claiming she was being threatened by a political party's founder, influential in certain southern districts, due to a "misconception" about her financial dealings with Veeramani.

Mr. Kumar then organised a meeting with the politician at an upscale hotel in Chennai, where the latter used "harsh language" at Shanthi, alleging that she was extorting Veeramani. "I realised something wasn't right at that moment," he said.

Later on, Mr. Kumar claimed, he met Shanthi at her home near Poes Garden, where she reportedly tried to explain her relationship with Veeramani and played the video featuring Veeramani engaging in obscene acts on her television.

"I took a video of what was playing on the television and immediately sought counsel with my lawyers on how to take this forward legally. Thereafter, I approached the police," he said.

Mr. Kumar said he was agast that he was being slandered over the issue. "I am ready to co-operate fully with the police to ensure justice for the victims," he said.

INBRIEF

Vijay visits Kolathur MLA at private hospital in Chennai

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday visited Kolathur M.L.A. Babu of the TVK, who has been undergoing treatment at a private hospital in Chennai. Mr. Babu, 75, was admitted to the hospital on September 9 owing to a respiratory ailment, and has been receiving treatment for nearly two weeks. He was under multidisciplinary medical care. A recent bulletin from the hospital said his clinical status was stable, and his response to the ongoing treatment was satisfactory. Mr. Vijay spent more than half an hour with Mr. Babu, and enquired with the doctors about his health.

Legislators cannot ask a court to treat their own silence as a nullity, says HC

Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan dismiss plea by AIADMK whip against the Tamil Nadu Assembly's amended resolution regarding the Mekedatu dam issue

Mohamed Imranullah S. CHENNAI

Legislators who either vote 'Aye' or remain silent without raising any objection during the proceedings of a House cannot, weeks later, ask a court to treat their own silence as a nullity, the Madras High Court said.

The first Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan said: "The principle that a person who stands by, watches an act take place, and permits it to occur without protest cannot subsequently be heard to complain of it, applies with as much force to the floor of a legislature as it does to any other public proceeding."

The observations were made while dismissing a writ petition filed by AIADMK whip Agri S.S. Krishnamurthy, who had challenged an amendment to a resolution passed by the Assembly on June 19. The amendment had urged the Centre to constitute a tribunal to resolve the dispute between Tamil Nadu and Karnataka over the proposed construction of a dam at Mekedatu.

The judges agreed with Advocate General Vijay Na-



rayan that what was put to a vote in the House was the amended resolution, which included the plea for the constitution of the tribunal, and that no MLA, including the writ petitioner, had raised any objection to the amendment before it was declared to have been passed unanimously.

"This is not a case of a citizen who was shut out or misled; it is a case of a Member, and of the party he belongs to, who was present in the House when the amendment was proposed, read out and voted upon. A challenge of this kind cannot succeed unless prejudice is ex facie apparent," the Bench said.

Authoring the verdict, the Chief Justice said: "The petitioner's own conduct, his continued presence through the debate, his silence at the vote, and his party's subsequent unsuccessful attempt to reopen the issue within the House

Courts are not obliged to entertain a challenge founded on an irregularity that the petitioner was in a position to object to at the time, and chose not to MADRAS HIGH COURT

itself demonstrates that no such prejudice exists. Courts exercising jurisdiction under Article 226 (power to issue writs) of the Constitution are not obliged to entertain a challenge founded on an irregularity that the petitioner himself was in a position to object to at the time, and chose not to."

The petitioner had complained that the plea for the constitution of a tribunal was not present in the draft resolution circulated to the MLAs, and it was added on the day of voting after Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay accepted a request made by Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin. However, the judges did not find anything wrong with the procedure adopted in the House.

"This is not an unusual way for a resolution to acquire its final shape on the floor of a House. Legislatures routinely accept oral

suggestions or modifications during a Minister's reply, and unless a rule in absolute terms forecloses that course, the presiding officer's acceptance of it, unopposed by the House, is not something a court can second-guess," the Bench said.

The court said the Speaker of a House does not merely record motions, but also regulates the conduct of business and controls its procedure. "The House and its presiding officer are the best judges of the propriety of their own proceedings. Rule 286 of the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly Rules vests the Speaker with the power to decide all questions of procedure arising in the House," it said.

There was a constitutional bar under Article 212, which forecloses judicial examination of the validity of legislative proceedings on the ground of irregularity of procedure. "The petitioner's own affidavit disclaims any challenge to the substance of the Assembly's opposition to the Mekedatu project; he confines himself to the process. That is exactly the kind of grievance Article 212 was designed to keep outside the doors of this Court," the Bench said.



Taking stock: Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay reviewed various aspects of power generation, distribution, and grid management at the TNPDCI headquarters in Chennai on Wednesday.

Chief Minister holds surprise inspection at TNPDCI headquarters

The Hindu Bureau CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday conducted a surprise inspection at the Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited (TNPDCI) headquarters in Chennai to review various aspects of power generation, distribution, and grid management.

Mr. Vijay, who was accompanied by Energy Resources Minister C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar during the review, enquired about the current electricity demand and generation, the power derived from renewable and non-renewable sources, the gap between electricity demand and generation capacity, and the growth in electricity demand owing to the prolonged summer.

Officials of TNPDCI explained to the Chief Minister the impact of the spike in electricity demand across the State, the constraints in procuring additional electricity from the power exchange to fill the demand-supply gap, the challenges in coal supply, the high cost of gas-based power generation, and the unexpected disruptions in generation at the central power stations.

The officials also explained the measures being undertaken across the State to meet the increasing electricity demand by strengthening the power distribution infrastructure and installing additional transformers and new power lines. They also gave a presentation on the overloaded networks, the replacement of ageing transformers and equipment, and the bolstering of field operations for speedy rectification of any power supply issues.

Later, the Chief Minister

Officials explained the impact of the spike in electricity demand across Tamil Nadu

visited the State Load Despatch Centre (SLDC), which is the nerve centre for grid management, to enquire about the tasks of managing the power load in real time by monitoring electricity generation, procurement, demand, and distribution across the State. He also visited the Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition (SCADA) Control Centre, which functions as the nerve centre for power distribution in Chennai, and interacted with officials on the real-time monitoring of the power distribution network in the city.

Visits 'Minnagam'

After completing his inspection of SLDC and SCADA, Mr. Vijay inspected 'Minnagam', the round-the-clock consumer service office that was established to receive electricity distribution complaints from the public throughout the State, and to ensure speedy communication of the issues to the officials concerned to get them resolved.

Pitching for modern technologies to be utilised for real-time monitoring of the power situation, the Chief Minister stressed that the State must be made self-reliant in the power sector. As part of this, he wanted the officials of TNPDCI to expedite various power generation projects within the stipulated timelines, enhance captive power generation, and speed up distribution infrastructure projects to ensure round-the-clock power supply.

Police conduct searches at five places linked to Veeramani

R. Sivaraman CHENNAI

Officials of the Central Crime Branch (CCB) on Wednesday conducted searches at five places linked to Gem Granites chairman R. Veeramani, who was arrested in a case involving allegations of sexual assault on minor girls. The searches included two bungalows belonging to Veeramani.

The police have also issued a Look Out Circular (LOC) against Prakash, son of a railway union leader, as part of the probe into financial transactions allegedly carried out by Veeramani and his associates

after the case was registered in October last year.

Sources said the searches, which began in the morning, were conducted on five premises linked to Veeramani, including his office on Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai and a guest house in Teynampet. A team of around 30 personnel, along with officials from the Anti-Vice Squad, took part in the searches.

The case was registered by the CCB on October 7, 2025, after an anonymous person handed over a pen drive and material allegedly linked to the offences. During the investigation, the police identified the elderly man seen in one of



The Gem Granites office on Cathedral Road. R. RAGU

the videos as Veeramani.

According to the police, Veeramani had rented a house in Teynampet and entrusted its management to Shanthi and her husband, Mahendra Simhan, who were accused of abetting the offences. Investiga-

tors alleged that Veeramani brought several minor girls to a bedroom in the house and sexually assaulted them. The police seized one of the videos allegedly containing the acts as evidence.

Subsequent searches at the residences and offices of the accused led to the seizure of further material, including photographs of several other minor girls and women. Veeramani and his alleged accomplices, Shanthi and Mahendra Simhan, were arrested and remanded in judicial custody on August 29.

The investigation was subsequently intensified, and the police identified

nine victims who were allegedly sexually assaulted by Veeramani.

Investigators are also examining allegations that large sums of money were transferred by Veeramani and his associates to certain individuals to facilitate their escape. The police are scrutinising the financial trail and property transactions involving Veeramani and his associates. A property transaction involving around ₹70 crore is among those being examined.

On Tuesday, the police arrested Ganesan, a former Gem Granites employee, for allegedly possessing a video showing

Veeramani in an obscene act with a minor and failing to report it.

Based on Ganesan's statement, CCB personnel conducted searches at five locations on Wednesday - Prakash's house in Perambur, his office in Royapetah, Veeramani's offices in Gopalapuram and his residence in T. Nagar, besides another premises.

Mobile phones, documents, and digital records were seized during the searches.

Meanwhile, former IPS officer and founder of We The Leaders Movement K. Annamalai called for a probe by a Special Investigation Team.

Palaniswami accuses TVK govt. of failing to take steps to prevent spread of dengue

The Hindu Bureau CHENNAI

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Wednesday accused the TVK-led government of not having taken steps to curb the spread of dengue.

Despite newspapers and the people cautioning the government about the prevalence of the disease, the government, which had shown "alacrity" in attributing the death of a student of Anna University to scrub typhus, had not displayed similar swiftness in preventing the spread of dengue, he said. He condemned the absence of Health Minister K.G. Arunraj at a review meeting held by the Director of Public Health. The Minister was trying to portray a picture of the impact being less this year when compared to previous years, but it was actually greater



Edappadi K. Palaniswami

than it was last year, the AIADMK leader said, calling upon the government to take intensive steps for the creation of awareness, and other preventive measures.

Meanwhile, AMMK leader T.T.V. Dhinakaran, in a social media post, referred to the visit of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay to the headquarters of the Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation, and criticised him for "posting social media reels" even

when he walked and stood, instead of attempting to solve issues such as electricity shortage and tariff hike, and law and order. He asked the Chief Minister why he did not pay attention to the demands of those agitating near the headquarters that the vacancies in the power utility be filled, and that those who had been selected through the Tamil Nadu Public Services Commission be issued appointment orders.

He ridiculed Energy Minister C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar who, according to him, had been offering comment on all matters other than those concerning his department, as if "he knew everything". The AMMK leader urged the State government and the power utility to make efforts to ensure uninterrupted power supply in the State.

DMK president demands immediate resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar

The Hindu Bureau CHENNAI

DMK president M.K. Stalin on Wednesday demanded the immediate resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, in the wake of media reports alleging that decisions were made without taking into account the objections of the other two Election Commissioners.

He also demanded that the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls be stopped, and that a fair and thorough investigation be conducted into everything that had transpired within the Election Commission (EC).

The DMK, along with other Opposition parties, has consistently opposed the deletion of crores of voters from the electoral rolls in the name of SIR. The exercise was "riddled with irregularities and sparked widespread unrest", particularly in West Bengal, Mr. Stalin said in an X post.



M.K. Stalin

Quoting a media report, Mr. Stalin said it had cast serious doubts over the results of every Assembly election held after the SIR exercise. "The investigation reveals that Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar had been acting unilaterally and in secrecy, without the concurrence of the other two Election Commissioners. Even more alarming is the revelation that Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi were kept in the dark about crucial decisions being taken within the very institution they jointly

oversee," he said.

He said their objections to decisions being taken without their knowledge were brushed aside on 14 occasions in 10 months. These revelations had severely eroded the credibility of the EC, he added.

"The Election Commission is a three-member body whose business must, as far as possible, be transacted unanimously. Where the Commissioners differ in opinion on any matter, the decision must be based on the majority view. If two of its three members were kept unaware of what was being done in the Commission's name, this cannot be dismissed as a mere internal or procedural matter. It constitutes a grave assault on Indian democracy. The credibility of an apex institution that is expected to function independently, transparently, and without political interference has been seriously compromised," Mr. Stalin said.

Panel to probe 'unexpected events' in BJP State unit

The Hindu Bureau CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu BJP has constituted a three-member State-level committee, in the wake of political developments and "unexpected events" in the party's State unit. The committee will submit its report to the State and Central units of the party.

Former legislator and the party's national executive member, H. Raja, is the convener of the committee. State joint treasurer M. Sivasubramanian and national council member R. Umarathi have been named as its members.

Complaints against some functionaries are believed to have prompted the BJP's State unit to constitute the committee.



Probe on: Officials inspect the railway track after four students were hit by a train in Tekkali, Srikakulam district on Wednesday. PTI

Four students killed in train accident in A.P.; one hospitalised

The Hindu Bureau
VISAKHAPATNAM

Four Intermediate students died, and another sustained grievous injuries on Wednesday, after being run over by a train between Naupada and Tekkali railway stations in Srikakulam district, Andhra Pradesh.

According to railway officials, the incident occurred at around 12:45 p.m. when Train No. 1817 (Rourkela-Gunupur Express) hit the five persons walking on the railway tracks.

The deceased have been identified as Anguwa Viskha Rao (17), Janni Di-leep Kumar (17), Janni Sharat Kumar (17), all hailing from Damara village in Tekkali mandal, and Savara Shiva (17) from Savara Street in Meliaputti village. All the victims were first-year Intermediate students of a government junior college in Tekkali. They died on the spot.

Another student, Gan-guwa Salman Raju (18) from Damara village, sus-

tained critical injuries. He was rushed to the government hospital in Tekkali.

Senior railway officials, along with Railway Protection Force and Government Railway Police personnel, rushed to the spot. The Self-Propelled Accident Relief Medical Equipment (SPARME) from Palasa railway station was mobilised to provide comprehensive relief support.

CM offers condolences

Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu expressed shock over the tragedy and offered condolences to the bereaved families.

Officials briefed the Chief Minister that the students failed to notice the train. Mr. Naidu directed the authorities to ensure advanced medical care for the injured student and extend the necessary support to the bereaved families.

Srikakulam Collector Swapnil Dinkar Pundkar instructed the police to submit a detailed report. The police have registered a case and launched an investigation.

SIT to probe graft allegations against Pinarayi in CMRL case

Inquiry initiated based on Enforcement Directorate's report; the agency has sought charges under PCA against former Keralam CM and his daughter; Home Department yet to issue official orders

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Kerala government has constituted a special investigation team (SIT) to probe the corruption allegations against Leader of the Opposition and former Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan, his daughter T. Veena, and son-in-law, former Minister P.A. Mohamed Riyas and others in the CMRL-Exalogic pay-off case.

The probe will be supervised by Additional Director-General of Police, Crime Branch, H. Venkatesh, with Superintendent of Police P. Vikraman leading probe, sources said.

The Home Department is yet to issue official orders constituting the SIT.



Hit the streets: A CPI(M) protest march in Kozhikode condemning the police inquiry ordered against Pinarayi Vijayan. K. RAGESH

The probe has been instituted on the basis of a report by the Enforcement Directorate to State Police Chief Ravada A. Chandrasekhar. The agency had sought registration of a case under the Prevention of Corruption Act (PCA) against Mr. Vijayan, Ms. Veena, and Mr. Riyas.

preliminary examination was necessary to determine whether a criminal case could be registered.

Earlier in the day, Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan said the government's intent was "not to target or take revenge on anyone."

'Vested interests'

Meanwhile, CPI(M) leader and former Minister P. Rajeev accused Mr. Satheesan of aiding the political interests of the BJP by ordering a police inquiry into the controversy.

The Chief Minister's claim that the government has no option, but to initiate an inquiry as per Supreme Court judgments, is part of the efforts to act as per the vested interests of the BJP, he alleged.

Toll rises to five in Telangana hospital fire

Siddharth Kumar Singh
HYDERABAD

The death toll from the fire at the Special Neonatal Care Unit (SNCU) of Rajiv Gandhi Institute of Medical Sciences (RIMS) in Telangana's Adilabad district has risen to five, with two more infants dying on Tuesday night.

The two infants were premature babies, born between 26 and 28 weeks of pregnancy, and weighed around one kg each, said Adilabad District Medical

Infants died after a fire ripped through a neonatal care unit of RIMS Adilabad

and Health Officer Sadhana.

The fire broke out around 11.40 p.m. on September 21 after an air conditioner in the reception area of the SNCU burst into flames. A five-day-old infant died in the incident, while another four-day-old infant died a few hours la-

ter. A third female infant was declared dead while being shifted to a nearby hospital.

As many as 25 infants were rescued from the SNCU following the fire and shifted to various government and private hospitals in the vicinity. They are undergoing treatment and are being monitored by medical teams.

Inquiry ordered

Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy has ordered an inquiry into the incident to

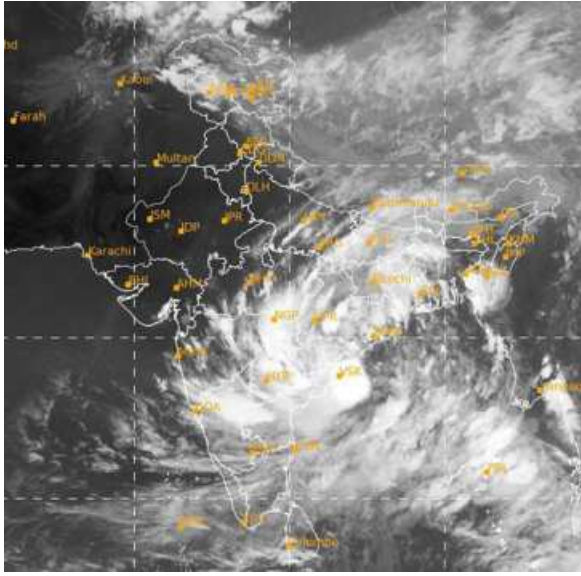
determine the circumstances that led to the fire. Health Minister C. Damaraj Raja Narasimha visited RIMS Adilabad on Tuesday and met the families of the affected infants.

He assured them of the government's support and reviewed the condition of the infants who were shifted to other hospitals.

The Telangana government, on Wednesday, announced an *ex-gratia* of ₹5 lakh to the families of the children who died in the fire.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Thursday:				Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalaya, Sikkim, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Keralam and Andaman & Nicobar Islands. Thunderstorm with lightning & gusty winds likely at isolated places over Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu and Puducherry			
CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		33.6	25.0	Kurnool		11.2	31.3
Ahmedabad		36.2	26.6	Lucknow		4.6	34.3
Aizawl		31.4	23.5	Madurai		37.0	25.6
Bengaluru		31.4	20.9	Mangaluru		30.6	25.4
Bhopal		31.4	22.4	Mumbai		1.8	32.2
Bhubaneswar	69.3	29.5	25.1	Mysuru		31.2	20.0
Chandigarh		35.9	23.2	New Delhi		36.4	24.8
Chennai		34.4	28.0	Patna		33.2	27.6
Coimbatore		32.3	22.8	Port Blair		25.4	27.7
Dehradun		33.8	21.3	Prayagraj		34.2	27.5
Gangtok	30.4	19.9	16.9	Puducherry		34.6	27.1
Goa		38.6	29.7	Pune		22.2	30.6
Guwahati		19.2	29.2	Raipur		114.4	31.1
Hubballi		27.0	22.0	Ranchi		22	24.3
Hyderabad	21.8	29.9	23.0	Shillong		19.3	23.6
Imphal		34.2	29.3	Shimla		27.6	16.8
Jaipur		36.7	25.1	Srinagar		29.7	11.0
Kochi		30.6	25.6	Thiruvananthapuram		3.6	32.4
Kohima		26.0	16.0	Tiruchirappalli		37.3	27.0
Kolkata		29.3	30.0	Vijayawada		15	27.4
Kozhikode		4.8	33.6	Visakhapatnam		95.4	25.9

CITIES				PM2.5				PM10				CODE				Yesterday			
Ahmedabad		36	90	28		171		128		128									
Bengaluru		20		52		43		113		113									
Chennai		24		10		21		70		93									
Delhi		13		68		71		215		147									
Hyderabad		11		15		40		58		53									
Kolkata			6		15		26		28		57								
Lucknow			6		31		49		88		82								
Mumbai		29		9		25		56		62									
Pune			8		32		95		64		87								
Visakhapatnam			3		24		20		11		18								

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS

E-TENDER NOTICE
Tender Notice No: PCMM/CLW/HWH/E-Procurement/26/37, Dated: 21/09/2026.
PCMM/CLW/HWH on behalf of the President of India invites electronic bids from established reliable manufacturer for supply of the followings. The following E-Tender/s is for supply of materials for manufacture of Electric Locomotive. The Prospective/ likely suppliers are requested to look up the website www.ireps.gov.in for detailed instructions. These E-Tenders only electronic offer bids shall be accepted. **Sl. No.:** **Tender No.:** **Description of Stores/ Quantities:** **Due On:** **Tender Cost** are as follows: [146]: 23265037B; 3 Core 185 sq.mm XLPE insulated and PVC sheathed stranded, screened steel strip armoured aluminium conductor cable rated for 11KV. (As per IS:7098-2). Make: POLY/CAB/ Havell's/ Finolex/ RR Kabel/ KEI or similar (Quantity Tolerance +/-) 5%. Item Category: Normal (Total PO value variation Permitted: Max 8 lacs); As per Tender/Documents; 10/10/2026; ₹0.00. [147]: 25255148A; Advanced Electrosurgical unit with APC Facility; As per Tender/Documents; 14/10/2026; ₹0.00. [148]: 31262539A; Key Multiplier Set for Non-Panel (Consisting of 02 items) (a) Key Multiplier -1 for M/C Compartment, (b) Key Multiplier -2 For Converter Module As Per Specn.; CLW/ES/3/0049/F; As per Tender/Documents; 15/10/2026; ₹0.00. [149]: 31261174B; Amplifier To Sensor Oil Circuit As Per Specification No. CLW/ES/3/0035/I; As per Tender/Documents; 23/10/2026; ₹0.00. [150]: 31261174C; Pressure Sensor Oil Circuit Transformer as per specification no. CLW/ES/3/0035/I; As per Tender/Documents; 23/10/2026; ₹0.00. PR8/496 PCMM/CLW/Howrah
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REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) FOR PROVIDING PROJECT CONSULTANT

Tender Notice No.: CPM-GS-MLG-PC-2026-07RT1. **Dated:** 19-09-2026; E-Tender are invited by the undersigned for the following work; **Tender No.:** CPM-GS-MLG-PC-2026-07RT1. **Sl. No. 1:** **Name of Work :** Request for Proposal (RFP) for providing Project consultant (PC) for providing "Comprehensive Consultancy services from the stage of Feasibility Study & DPR preparation for elimination of Level Crossing gates in N.F. Railway by constructing ROB and/ RUB/ LHS/Other Structures/ Road Diversion as required including Detailed Design of required components of finalised scheme, Tendering for execution of works as per finalized scheme, Techno-Managerial Consultancy, Processing & Facilitation for land acquisition, Project supervision Services/Project Management Consultancy etc. for execution of work till closure of level crossings/ Defect Liability Period of execution contract". **Advertised Value:** ₹84,21,83,397.91/-; **Earnest Money :** ₹43,60,900/-; **Date & time of closing of tender at 15:30 hrs. and opening of tender at 15:30 hrs. on 13-10-2026.** For details please visit in the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. **CPM/GS/MLG/N.F. Railway**
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

ENGINEERING WORKS
E-Tender Notice No. DCBL/11/2026/MLG, Dated: 15-09-2026. Open E-Tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following works: **Tender No.:** **DCBL/152026MLG: Name of works:** Maintenance of Intelligent Water Level Monitoring Instruments (WLM) for two years for identified Important/Major bridges under Bridge-Line Unit of N.F. Railway (Remote site annual maintenance & technical supports and hardware AMC for two years at various Bridges over NFR). **Approximate Tender Value:** ₹5,28,65,703/-; **Bid Security:** ₹10,57,300/-; **Date of closing of Tender:** 08-10-2026 at 15.00 hrs. **Date of Opening of Tenders:** 08-10-2026 at 15.05 hrs. at Deputy Chief Engineer/ Bridge-Line/Maligaon, Guwahati-781011 (Assam). For details please visit www.ireps.gov.in
Dy. CE/Bridge-Line/Maligaon
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
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WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY
Mechanical Branch
OPEN TENDER
E-Tender is invited on behalf of the President of India, acting through Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (Freight)/ NKJ, ROH depot NKJ, West Central Railway, for the following work:- **NIT No. & Date:** JBP-M-Tender-29-2026, Dated 18.09.2026. **Name of work with location:** Blocking & reduction in height of doors of 7500 BOXN wagons at ROH Depot NKJ. **Adv. Value of the work:** ₹ 43,35,55,285/-; **Earnest Money:** ₹ 86,71,100/-; **Period of Completion:** 26 Months. **Tender Closing date & time:** 12.10.2026, 15:00 Hrs. The complete information of the above E-Tenders is available in website <https://ireps.gov.in> and also placed on the notice board of the Divisional Railway Manager (Mech.) office of West Central Railway, Jabalpur. Tenders other than in the form of e-bid shall not be accepted against above tenders.
स्वच्छ भारत अभियान
एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
(Survey & Construction)
No. NWR-PGMS-DESIGN-1-2026-27, Dated:-18/09/2026
For and on behalf of the President of India, Chief Administrative Officer (Construction), North Western Railway, Head Quarter building, Jawahar Circle, Jaipur invites online Open E-tendering System (Two Packet) for the following work on prescribed electronic forms - 1. **Tender No. :** NWR-PGMS-DESIGN-1-2026-27 2. **Name of the Work :** Request for Proposal (RFP) for providing Project General Management Services Design for CAO-CON North Western Railway. 3. **Mode of Tender :** Open (Two Packet System) 4. **Estimated Project Cost :** ₹36,53,13,472.00 (Thirty Six Crore Fifty Three Lakh Thirteen Thousand Four Hundred Seventy Two Rupees and Zero Paise Only). 5. **Bid Security :** ₹73,06,300.00 (Seventy Three Lakh Six Thousand Three Hundred Rupees and Zero paisa only). 6. **Completion Period :** 36(Thirty Six) Months 7. **Tender Closing Date and Time :** 02.11.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. 8. **Website particulars where complete details of E-tender can be seen :** www.ireps.gov.in **Note:** No manual tender/s will be accepted. 1366-CQ/26
Follow us on: www.facebook.com/NWRrailways www.instagram.com/NWRrailways www.youtube.com/NWRrailways

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

Dr. N.S.SRINIVASAN (89), Uncle of Mr. N.P. Murali, Chennai - 600 017, expired on 29-09-2026. Eyes donated to Rotary Rajan Eye Bank (Project of Rotary Club of Madras T.Nagar), Chennai-17 (Ph: 28340500).

OBITUARY

Dr. N.S. SRINIVASAN
Homeopathy
D.O.B 7.10.1937
D.O.D 23.9.2026

With deep sorrow, we bid farewell to **Dr. N.S. SRINIVASAN** - healer to many, and a guiding light to our family since childhood. His wisdom and warmth shaped who we are today.
Friends & Family
Call : 9841059210

DEATH

ANNIVERSARIES

TWENTY FIFTH ANNIVERSARY

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02.10.1982 - 24.09.2001
"Your noble soul continues to guide and bless us"
M.SUNDARARAJ
M.MARY ELSYBAI

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES

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CHAUTHA UTHAVNA

Prarthna Sabha

In loving memory of our Beloved Father

Born 28th September 1943

Departed 22nd September 2026

Shri Khatri Mohanlal Mukanchandji Choonchha

has attained the divine feet of Lord Shri Krishna

on 22 September 2026

Prarthna Sabha

to pay tribute and offer prayers for the departed soul.

FRIDAY 25 September, 2026

9:00 AM TO 11:00 AM

At our residence Khatri Villa

No: 9, Thambuswamy Road, Kilpauk, Opposite Civil Supply Office, Chennai - 600010

With Grief Wife Shanti Devi

Son & Daughter in law Suresh Khatri & Rekha Devi Khatri

Grandchildren Tejash Khatri & Neha Khatri & Khatri Family

MOHANLAL JEWELLERS PVT LTD



BRICs gatherings always trigger heated debates in India. The primary reason is the importance that the strategic and policymaking community, comprising both optimists and sceptics, attaches to this platform, of which India is an integral pillar. While optimists argue that BRICS could function as an institution capable of multilateralising the global order, or expediting that transition, sceptics highlight the grouping's internal divisions and worry about its possible domination by Russia and China. A third group writes off BRICS altogether, dismissing it as little more than an annual gathering that generates strategic noise. They argue that India should be wary of close association with the grouping and instead focus on preserving and expanding its partnership with the United States, which, in their view, is the only viable path to India's rise.

The 18th BRICS summit, held in New Delhi on September 12-13, 2026, attracted greater national and global attention because of its timing and location. It was the first BRICS annual summit since the U.S. and Israel launched their unprovoked war against Iran, in India's extended neighbourhood, on February 28, 2026. The summit, which brought together the Presidents of Iran, Russia and China, among other leaders, was hosted by India, a close strategic partner of the U.S. and Israel.

Consensus in Delhi

Despite its internal contradictions and the broader chaos enveloping international politics, the summit can be seen as a success on multiple levels. That New Delhi could forge a consensus among the 11 member-countries, including the United Arab Emirates (UAE) and Iran, which are involved in an undeclared conflict, was itself an achievement. The Delhi Declaration shows that, despite their differences and even disputes, member-countries continue to find value in supporting a BRICS worldview rooted in the pursuit of a more representative global order.

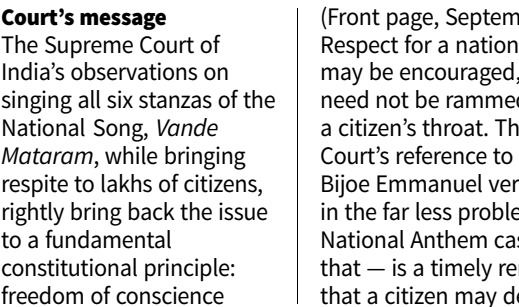
The consensus was reached through compromises by all parties. Consider India's position. Prime Minister Narendra Modi was in Israel just two days before Israel and the U.S. started bombing Iran. India initially refrained from condemning the attacks or the assassination of Iran's Supreme Leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei. This created an impression that New Delhi was siding with the U.S. and Israel. India also watched from the sidelines as Pakistan seized on the diplomatic opening created by the war and stepped in as a mediator between the U.S. and Iran. But India quickly repositioned itself as a traditional balancer in West Asia.

Multilateral platforms such as the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) and BRICS provided New Delhi with space to restore that balancing posture without causing strategic damage to its bilateral relationships. India strongly endorsed the Bishkek resolution of the SCO in September, condemning the strikes on Iran and expressing condolences to the country

India-NZ FTA shows how smaller deals can complement big-bang trade pacts

The India-New Zealand Free Trade Agreement (FTA), set to come into force on October 20, is a good example of why India is right in simultaneously pushing for trade deals with smaller trade partners along with the major global economies. On the face of it, it would be easy to dismiss the \$1.1 billion of bilateral goods trade between the two countries as being less than 1% of India's total goods trade. A doubling by 2030, as envisaged under the deal, is still a minuscule amount. Yet, trade is not simply a macroeconomic indicator. It is also a source of livelihood for lakhs of businesses, nearly half of which are micro, small, and medium enterprises. These exporters need all the help that they can get in the current trade environment. Adverse developments related to tariffs or the closure of trade routes can be mitigated to an extent by a nimble rerouting of trade to other countries where Indian exporters receive an advantage. With 100% U.S. tariffs looming and a trade deal with Washington remaining elusive, India needs to open up as many alternative channels for its exporters as possible. The New Zealand FTA delivers – India has managed to receive duty-free access on 100% of its exports, a historic concession. India has a good mix of capital- and labour-intensive exports to New Zealand that stand to benefit. Textiles make up about 14% of India's exports, while pearls and semi-precious stones constitute another 5% or so. On the capital-intensive side, one-third of India's exports are pharmaceuticals, parts of nuclear reactors, vehicular parts, mineral fuels, electrical machinery, and iron and steel.

India has also done well in its handling of sensitive sectors. While the opening up of India's dairy sector was a major demand by the New Zealand negotiators, India held firm and excluded it from the deal. In total, nearly 30% of India's import lines have been kept outside the tariff concessions. On labour mobility, India has won some valuable concessions on visas for workers and students. At a time when several western countries are clamping down on foreign worker inflows, such alternative routes provide relief. India has also extracted a commitment from New Zealand to facilitate investments of \$20 billion in India over 15 years, smaller but along the same lines as in the agreement with the EFTA bloc. India needs foreign investment not just for its economic growth but also to manage its balance of payments. This FTA is a good blueprint on how India can use its growing international heft to negotiate overwhelmingly in its favour.



Varghese
K. George



The very structure of BRICS offers India space to pursue strategic autonomy amid intensifying great-power rivalries

over the killing of Khamenei. It also hosted Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian for the Delhi BRICS summit, even as the war in West Asia grinds on. The image of Mr. Modi walking hand in hand with Mr. Pezeshkian is unlikely to fade any time soon in Washington or Tel Aviv.

Second, while there is no immediate resolution to the border problems with China, which continue to simmer, there is momentum in efforts to reset ties. Multilateral forums such as BRICS provide a platform for India and China to remain engaged even when high-level bilateral visits are not taking place. Their differences are not going to disappear; they have to learn to manage their troubled relationship. History suggests that a lack of engagement between competing major powers can only deepen mistrust, while deepening mistrust, combined with the security dilemma stemming from their competition, could have dangerous consequences. So, it is important for India and China to stay engaged, bilaterally and multilaterally, creating guardrails for competitive coexistence.

Third, on all the major global issues of the present – artificial intelligence regulation, the rules governing global trade and finance, climate change, border conflicts, and the role and status of multilateral bodies – BRICS members may have different approaches and priorities, but they converge on the point that unilateralism by any bloc or power is detrimental to their interests and to the planet.

The Washington predictability

The context in which the Delhi summit was held is also crucial. The total predictability of the U.S. approach – rather than the unpredictability that some commentators labour to establish – towards the rest of the world is that it does not care much about anything other than its own dominance. Several BRICS members have had their own difficult experiences with the U.S., and they are trying to chart their own paths forward. India, a few months ago, was slapped with varying tariffs by Washington. India was also one of the countries most affected economically by the U.S.-Israel war on Iran. On September 16, the U.S. House passed the Russia sanctions Bill, seeking to impose tariffs of up to 100% on countries including India.

India's foreign policy under Mr. Modi has been interpreted by a section of the strategic commentariat as an evident tilt towards the U.S. camp. Statements by Mr. Modi himself in the early years of his premiership that India had overcome its "hesitation of history" in ties with Washington gave further impetus to this view, though there has also been the parallel official formulation of '*sabke saath*' foreign policy, or multi-alignment. India has always had a more complex view of history. And even if it has overcome its "hesitation of history", it has not abandoned the hesitations of its strategic realism.

When India looks back at history and looks around the world today, it sees that countries that

domestic manufacturing. More than 600 QCO-covered products remain to be reassessed, including several critical intermediate inputs used across key manufacturing sectors such as chemicals, steel, textiles, machinery and electronics, and rubber and plastics.

Existing regulations can place a disproportionate burden on smaller industrial players, both by constraining their access to critical inputs and by imposing relatively high compliance costs. Given the extensive downstream linkages of these inputs, the next phase of QCO rationalisation should focus particularly on regulations affecting intermediate goods and assess their implications not only for product quality but also for input availability, costs, competitiveness and domestic value addition.

Findings of a recent study

In this regard, a recent CSEP study examined this question in detail for firms that use chemicals. Chemicals are critical intermediate inputs for downstream sectors such as rubber and plastics, pharmaceuticals and electronics, among others. The first QCO for a chemical product was introduced in 2018, and the number of chemical products covered rose to 52 by 2024. Consequently, the share of chemical-using firms exposed to regulation on the input side rose from 11.8% in 2019 to 56.6% in 2024.

When examining the impact of QCOs on chemicals on downstream user industries, the study finds that the effects vary considerably by firm size. Among larger firms, input QCOs are associated with a 9.6% increase in production alongside a sharp 37% decline in gross value added (GVA). This suggests that while larger firms can sustain and even expand output, this comes at the cost of lower value addition, potentially reflecting higher input costs and their ability to

become frontiers in great-power rivalries often pay a huge price. If Pakistan's story is not instructive enough, there are two live battlefronts that illustrate this every day – the UAE and Ukraine.

The UAE and Iran would have been better off dealing with each other than facing the situation in which they currently find themselves. The UAE-Iran bilateral meeting on the sidelines of BRICS in Delhi marks an acknowledgment of this lesson and a quest to use multilateral platforms to address bilateral challenges. Ukraine, which, backed by the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO), has been fighting Russia for more than four years, does not have any such platform to maintain direct contact with Moscow – which leaves Kyiv's diplomatic options totally dependent on the whims and wishes of Brussels and Washington.

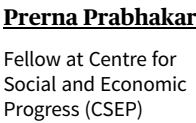
India's learning

This is not to argue that India should downgrade its relations with the U.S. The strategic partnership with Washington is extremely important for India's progress and development, but what India must not allow itself to become, at any cost, is a frontline in the U.S.-China competition. BRICS enables India to pursue that path without having to champion an anti-U.S. agenda or undermine its cooperation with Washington. The U.S., which had come to terms with India's firm adherence to strategic autonomy, has recently been pushing the envelope to draw New Delhi into a more subordinate relationship. For Washington, this is an ongoing theme. But India should pursue multiple pathways to its rise rather than succumb to the temptations of unequal great-power alliances.

While it is true that there are serious internal divisions among BRICS members, there is also a larger reality of external convergence of interests among them. BRICS is not an organisation like the G-7, where American primacy and the western order are accepted by all member-countries. Nor is it the case that every multilateral or plurilateral grouping is converging on all points.

The divisions within BRICS, to a certain extent, prevent any one country from dominating the grouping, while the external convergence of interests – their shared belief that the post-war international system is unfair and that a more representative order should be built – could hold the group together as it lays the foundations and builds the blocks of a new order. The dialectical relationship between internal contradictions and external convergence could ultimately produce a synthesis, which is increasingly evident in the case of BRICS. The contradictions within are therefore not a reason to question the grouping's existence; they are, in fact, part of the reason why it should exist and flourish.

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Visiting Fellow at the
Crawford School
of Public Policy

India's Quality Control Order (QCO) reset must go further in a changing global trade order

Court's message

(Front page, September 23). Respect for a national song may be encouraged, but it need not be rammed down a citizen's throat. The Court's reference to the Bijeoe Emmanuel verdict — in the far less problematic National Anthem case, at that — is a timely reminder that a citizen may decline to

sing when doing so conflicts with deeply held religious or conscientious beliefs. National symbols should unite citizens, not place their conscience on trial. A democracy is secure enough to distinguish between disrespect and conscientious dissent, and between voluntary,

spontaneous patriotism and compelled conformity. One should not forget that there is more to patriotism than mere singing, sloganeering and chest-thumping.

M. Jameel Ahmed,
Mysuru

Unsafe Delhi
It is horrendous that the

capital city has become unsafe and dangerous for women ("Delhi L-G directs formation of 'Pink Force' to curb crime", September 23). Unless stringent laws are put in place and speedy punishment is ensured for perpetrators, such incidents will continue to occur and young lives scarred. It is the

confidence of perpetrators that they can evade justice that encourages them to continue such abhorrent and abominable acts.

Balagopal Gopinath,
Keerikkad, Alappuzha, Keralam

Letters emailed to
letters@thehindu.co.in
must carry the postal address
and the full name.

Limits of the casting vote at Tata Sons

On September 17, the board of Tata Sons voted on a third five-year term for N. Chandrasekaran as Executive Chairman. Mr. Chandrasekaran abstained from voting voluntarily and the recorded result was four to one. Within hours the Tata Trusts, owners of about 66% of Tata Sons, called the decision legally void. The claim rests on how several provisions of the Articles of Association, the company’s rulebook, fit together.

With a 66% share, the Trusts could have packed the board. Instead, under Article 104B, the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust and the Sir Ratan Tata Trust act jointly and nominate one-third of the directors. So now, on a board of six, two seats are held by Noel Tata and Venu Srinivasan.

Article 121 gives these seats their weight; any matter the board decides by majority requires the affirmative vote of a majority of these nominated directors. If the votes are equal, the chairman has a casting vote.

The chairmanship is built in steps. A person must first be a director. A new Chairman of the Board is appointed under Article 118, subject to the voting requirement in Article 121 (whether it also governs a reappointment is disputed). Only a Chairman may be made Executive Chairman under Article 105(b).

On September 17, the nominees split – Mr. Srinivasan for and Mr. Tata against. Harish Manwani, an independent director chairing the item in Mr. Chandrasekaran’s place, reportedly used a casting vote in favour.

In the Cyrus Mistry litigation in 2019, the



Prasanth Raju

Advocate practising in the Bombay High Court. Views are personal

National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) called the nominees’ affirmative vote indispensable, which the top court later upheld in 2021. Neither court had to decide whether a casting vote can cure a split between the two nominees.

Where the readings part Tata Sons relies on two legal opinions. Senior advocate Sudipto Sarkar has advised that a casting vote can break a tie between the nominees as well as a board tie – that whoever presides may use it because Article 121 says Chairman, and not Chairman of the Board. Justice B.N. Srikrishna, a former Supreme Court judge, agrees and advised that since no majority could be found between the nominees, the casting vote ended the deadlock. However, the Trusts referred to a contrary opinion held by former Chief Justice D.Y. Chandrachud.

The company’s reading has a textual footing: the words about equal votes do not say whose votes are meant. But Article 121 has two parts and they must be read together. The first sets a condition: a majority of the ‘Trusts’ nominees must support the decision. The second breaks a tie when the board is evenly split. The board as a whole was not evenly divided; the only split was between the two nominees. With two nominees, a majority means both. When Justice Srikrishna says no majority could be found, it means that the condition was not met. The company’s reading uses the tie-break to make up for it. The Trusts’ reading gives each part its own role. If both nominees support a decision and the other four

directors divide evenly, the board is tied three all, and the casting vote settles it.

Other parts of the rulebook support this reading. Articles 104B, 86 and 118 resolve any difference between the two Trusts by a majority of their trustees, never by the chair of a board meeting.

Defending these rules against Mr. Mistry in 2019, Tata Sons itself argued that where the Articles require the support of particular directors, a decision passes only if those directors agree. Here, those are the two Trust nominees. Mr. Manwani is an independent director; on the Trusts’ reading, his casting vote cannot stand in for their agreement. The minutes of the meeting Mr. Tata has produced record the February 2022 extension of Mr. Chandrasekaran’s tenure as made under Article 118, and Article 118 is itself subject to Article 121.

The advisers argue, with some force, that no selection committee was needed for a reappointment, and that Mr. Chandrasekaran’s August letter (wherein he detailed he did not wish to hold the post) did not bind him. Neither point changes Article 121’s arithmetic: with both nominees present, the required majority was two.

Only a director can be chairman, so directorship matters. The August general meeting was adjourned for want of a quorum before shareholders could consider Mr. Chandrasekaran’s reappointment.

The Trusts are weighing legal proceedings. A mutual settlement is preferred to a lengthy litigation, which could spiral into uncertainty about the group’s leadership.

A mutual settlement is preferred to a lengthy litigation, which could spiral into uncertainty about the group’s leadership

Delhi’s infra-governance problem

Every year, news of an infrastructural disaster in Delhi taking precious student lives sends shock-waves across the nation. Investigations into enforcement of building bye-laws, suspension of officials, and arrest of landlords gain momentum for some time and slowly settle down until yet another year invokes a fresh infrastructural horror. It is Satya Niketan now, it was a flooded basement in Rajinder Nagar two years ago. Delhi houses millions of students who move to the city either to join premier institutes or to prepare for competitive government exams. This influx of students has created a sprawling ecosystem of largely unregulated Paying Guest (PG) accommodations and coaching centres.

PGs have over time transformed from an extra room in a house rented out for extra cash to full-blown commercial establishments. Moreover, several coaching centres also operate in certain floors of buildings marked as residential establishments. This changes the nature and use-type of the building from residential to partly or wholly commercial and ideally makes them subject to a completely different set of safety norms. Municipal laws, regulations and bye-laws govern safety norms for residential and commercial buildings in the Union Territory but there is a significant enforcement gap which is unable to identify/accommodate these hybrid establishments. Regulations that would typically apply to similar establishments such as schools and college hostels are not directly applicable



Kartavi Satyarathi

Senior Resident Fellow, Vidhi Centre for Legal Policy

to these establishments. Therefore, PGs and coaching institutes need to be recognised as a separate category of mixed-use educational buildings under municipal and urban local body regulations.

Delhi’s regulatory framework is split across the Master Plan of Delhi (MPD), the Unified Building Bye-Laws (UBBL) and the Ministry of Education’s 2024 coaching centre guidelines. Together, they create an odd mismatch between the law on paper and the way it actually functions. The MPD does not specifically mention PGs, and while the UBBL recognises coaching centres as an educational building, development controls prescribed under the bye-laws are not applicable to coaching centres. The Guidelines lack teeth and cover only broad infrastructural requirements. Thus, the regulatory landscape falls severely deficient in accounting for the on-ground realities of the city, especially student-focused areas such as Rajinder Nagar, Mukherjee Nagar and Satya Niketan.

The road ahead The regulatory landscape needs to solve for two gaps – one, the absence of substantive safety standards for mixed-use educational buildings, and two, the lack of routine enforcement. Both the Delhi Development Authority and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi need to acknowledge coaching centres and PGs as a separate category of land-use. Specific standards applicable to such mixed-use educational buildings need to be developed prescribing requirements such as appropriate protection

PGs and coaching institutes need to be recognised as a separate category of mixed-use educational buildings under municipal and urban local body regulations

The backdrop in which the U.S. Fed raised interest rate

Inflation in the U.S. hit a peak in May, at 4.2%, after which it climbed down to 3.4% – far above the Federal Reserve’s target of 2%

DATA POINT

Nitika Francis

On September 16, the U.S. Federal Reserve raised the short-term interest rate – its main policy rate, broadly comparable to the Reserve Bank of India’s repo rate – for the first time in three years, by 25 basis points from a range of 3.5% to 3.75% to a range of 3.75% to 4%.

Chart 1 shows the short-term interest rate, also called the federal funds rate, seeing its first increase this month after being brought down a few times since 2023.

Coming ahead of the mid-term polls in the U.S., the interest rate hike disappointed supporters of President Donald Trump as its current Chair Kevin Warsh was hand-picked by Mr. Trump, who has been vociferous in his opposition to increases in the interest rate.

Soon after the announcement about the increase, Mr. Trump took to Truth Social to register his opposition and said the interest rate “should be 1 % or less” and argued that higher rates have allowed other countries to benefit.

However, multiple indicators that influence each other show that the increase was almost inevitable. The key indicator is the inflation rate that has not come down to acceptable limits since the beginning of the war the U.S. and Israel started with Iran earlier this year. Long-term bond yields, pushed up by inflation fears and by heavy government borrowing, added to the pressure on the Fed as holding the rates risked signalling that it was going soft on inflation.

Need to bring down inflation

Mr. Warsh, along with 11 members of the Federal Open Market Committee, made this decision to combat inflation. “The plain fact is that inflation is too high and has been for too long,” he said at a press conference.

As per the Consumer Price Index data released for August, overall inflation in the States continued to be at 3.4% in August. **Chart 3** depicts the U.S.’s rate of inflation throughout 2026.

The sharpest jump in inflation took place in March, after the beginning of the U.S.-Israel war with Iran in February.

Inflation in the U.S. hit a peak in May, at 4.2%, after which it climbed down to 3.4%, still far above the Federal Reserve’s 2% target, which it measures using the Personal Consumption Expenditures (PCE) price index.

Meanwhile, the benchmark 10-year U.S. Treasury bond yields also started increasing after the Iran conflict, resulting in higher borrowing costs for the government.

Chart 2 shows the increase, which was seen in other major economies as well. While the chart shows monthly data till August, the yield on the 10-year bonds crossed the key threshold of 5% on September 14.

Rising debt

One of the factors influencing the markets to drive the long-term bond yields up is the public debt of the U.S., which is increasing at a rate faster than the growth of its Gross Domestic Product (GDP).

The country’s debt-to-GDP ratio saw sharp rises in 2008, during the housing finance crisis, and its highest jump of more than 25 percentage points was in 2020, during the COVID-19 pandemic (**Chart 4**).

As of the first quarter of 2026, debt was 122.6% of the country’s GDP. This ratio is nearly twice of what it was just 20 years ago, in 2006.

The cost of servicing the increased debt is so high that the net interest payments by the U.S. government (**Chart 5**) is higher than its spending on Medicare, health, and interestingly even defence – which according to the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute accounts for one-third of global military spending.

Putting out fires

The data for the charts were sourced from Federal Reserve Economic Data (by the Research Department at the Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis) and USAspending.gov



Tough times: U.S. President Donald Trump shakes hands with Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh in the White House in Washington, D.C. REUTERS

CHART 2: The long-term bond yields of some other key economies have also gone up along with that of the U.S. Japan’s yield hit 2.94%, the highest since 1998

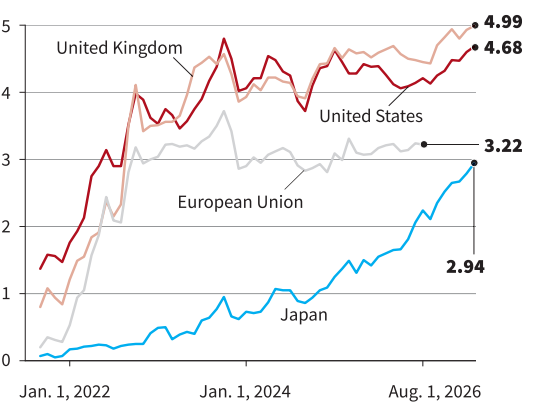


CHART 4: The U.S.’s public debt is increasing at a rate faster than the growth of its Gross Domestic Product

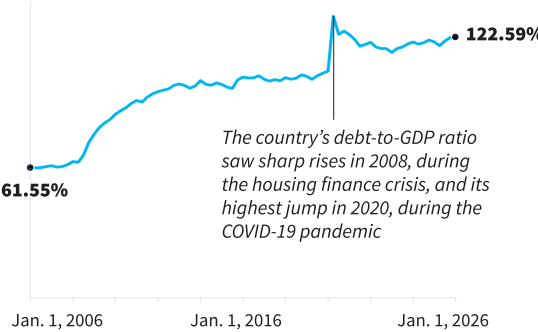


CHART 1: The increase in the short-term interest rate by the U.S. Federal Reserve for the first time since July 2023

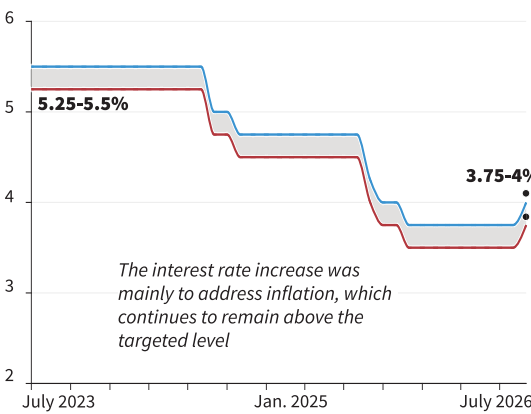


CHART 3: As fuel prices soared after the war began, inflation in the U.S. accelerated and hit retail and food prices, and is much higher than the Fed’s target of 2%

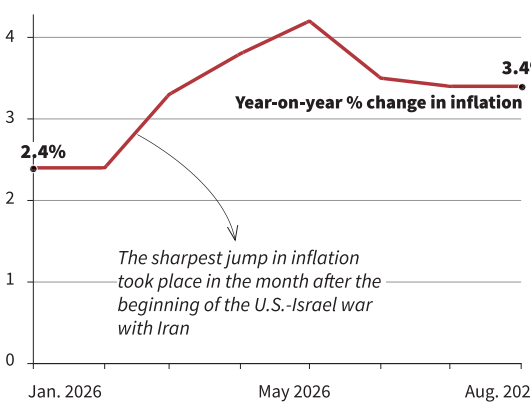
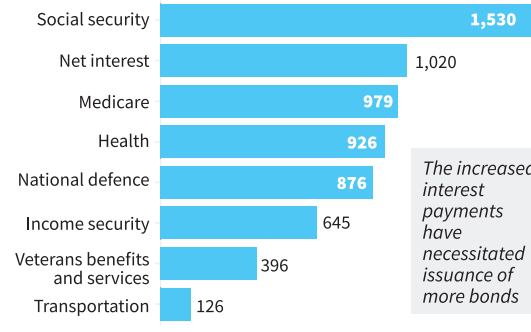


CHART 5: Net interest payments by the U.S. government is only smaller than its social security expenditure. Values in \$ billion



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 24, 1976

Mars may have more water than Earth

Pasadena (California), September 23: Mars is like a giant ice-lollipop packed with vast quantities of frozen water – and it might even possess more water than earth, according to U.S. scientists.

Viking project scientists here said the martian north polar cap had been found to contain huge amounts of water ice and the rest of the red planet’s rocky surface might be a thin blanket over an enormous ice sheet.

The announcement of the Viking space probe findings ended a long-standing dispute over whether martian polar caps might be composed of frozen carbon dioxide instead of water ice.

The experts made it clear at a press conference there was more water on mars than they ever expected.

“Mars can perhaps be described as an iceberg floating in a sea of rock and the north pole is the top,” said Dr. Barney Famer, head of the Viking Water Vapour Mapping Team.

Dr. William McElroy, an atmospheric scientist, said it was possible there was more water in various forms on mars than on earth, “Everywhere you look on mars you see water,” he said.

“There was a time when we thought there was no water on mars,” Viking project scientist Gerald Soffen told reporters. “Now we find there are massive amounts of water frozen in the north polar cap.”

The discovery was made when the orbiting vehicle which carried the Viking landing craft to mars made low, temperature reading passes over the north pole.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 24, 1926

New cure for Malaria

Berlin, September 23: A new cure for Malaria, by means of a synthetic preparation “Plasmochin”, was explained at the Scientists’ and Doctors’ Congress at Duesseldorf. It was claimed that it was more effective than quinine. Experiments were at first conducted by Professor Shell on lunatics who were specially infected with malaria germs, after which “Plasmochin” was successfully tested by Professor Muchlens of Hahmburg Tropical Institute on over a hundred victims of malaria from various parts of world. In many cases, permanent cure is believed to have been effected.

CM
YK



External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar with U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio in New York on Wednesday. @DRSJAISHANKAR/X

Jaishankar takes up U.S. sanctions law in meeting with Rubio

Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI

In their first meeting since the United States enacted the Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act (SRIA), External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar raised concerns about the law with U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio in New York on Wednesday.

The law, which mandates U.S. President Donald Trump to penalise countries that buy Russian oil with up to 100% tariffs and extends sanctions on Iran trade, could affect India if implemented after the stipulated one-month period.

In a social media post, Mr. Jaishankar said he had “reiterated India’s interests and concerns with regard to SRIA” and discussed the situations in Ukraine and Iran. In a strongly worded reaction to the U.S. Congress passing the Act last week, the Ministry of External Affairs had said it conveyed to various U.S. interlocutors in recent months that the move would have “implications” for both the India-U.S. bi-

lateral relationship and the international energy market if India is pressured by the U.S. to drop its intake of Russian Ural, which currently makes up 51% of India’s total crude imports.

After the meeting, Mr. Rubio sidestepped the issue. In a social media post about the meeting, he said, “Together, we are building on the U.S.-India strategic partnership and coordinating on key regional priorities and upcoming multi-lateral efforts.”

Mr. Jaishankar and Mr. Rubio are also understood to be preparing for meetings between Mr. Trump and Prime Minister Narendra Modi later this year, with a possible meeting at the ASEAN Summit in November and then a bilateral expected in mid-December, when Mr. Trump hosts G20 Summit in Miami.

This is the third year in succession that India has failed to host the Quad Summit, and New Delhi has been keen to set a date later this year or early next year for Mr. Trump and leaders of Australia and Japan to travel to India.

SIR is illegal and needs to be reversed: former CEC Quraishi

Delimitation and SIR are intertwined and tailored to favour BJP, say Opposition leaders at *The Hindu* event; government has not yet prorogued the Monsoon Session of Parliament as it plans to bring the Bills around Oct. 11, says Jairam Ramesh

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls is illegal and needs to be reversed, former Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) S.Y. Quraishi said on Wednesday.

Mr. Quraishi made these remarks at an event to launch the book *The Delimitation Debate: The Union and its Units*, published by The Hindu Group. The book contains essays that examine critical questions of representation, federalism and demographic change.

Speaking at the event, Communist Party of India (Marxist) MP John Brittas said the issues of SIR and delimitation are inter-linked as the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) wants these tailored to make the party win.

Congress communications chief Jairam Ramesh said the Narendra Modi government has not prorogued the Monsoon Session of Parliament even after 41 days of Parliament being adjourned *sine die*, as it is keen to bring the Delimitation Bill during Navratri.

‘Dubious procedure’
Speaking at a panel discussion, moderated by *The Hindu’s* Political Editor Nistula Hebbar, Mr. Quraishi referred to the newsbreak by *The Indian Express* in



(From left) Sobhana Nair, Senior Deputy Editor, *The Hindu*; Nistula Hebbar, Political Editor, *The Hindu*; Javed Ali Khan, Rajya Sabha MP, SP; John Brittas, Rajya Sabha MP, CPI(M); Jairam Ramesh, Rajya Sabha MP, Congress; S.Y. Quraishi, former Chief Election Commissioner; Sanjeev Chopra, author and historian; Raja Sekhar Vundru, author; Varghese K. George, Resident Editor, *The Hindu*, Delhi; and Suresh Nambath, Editor, *The Hindu* at the launch of *The Delimitation Debate: The Union and its Units* in New Delhi on Wednesday. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

which it was mentioned that there were major differences between Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and the other two Election Commissioners, Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi.

“I have been saying from the beginning, about a year and a half ago, that it is highly undesirable. And today it has come out that it was illegal,” Mr. Quraishi said.

Questioning the procedure adopted for the ongoing SIR exercise, Mr. Quraishi described it as “dubious”.

“I have been opposing it, and now today’s revelations in *The Indian Express* have actually exposed the fact that the Election Commissioners themselves have been questioning the procedures being followed. In fact, it has raised a serious question of the legality of the decision. And

all illegal decisions need to be reversed,” he said.

His co-panelist Sanjeev Chopra, former director of the Lal Bahadur Shastri Academy of Administration, argued for smaller States for a more representative democracy.

Raja Sekhar Vundru, former Additional Chief Secretary, Haryana government, argued for a system like France where there can be two rounds of voting so that the ultimate winner of an election should have at least 50% of the votes polled.

A separate panel discussion, moderated by Senior Deputy Editor Sobhana Nair, which included Mr. Ramesh, Mr. Brittas and Samajwadi Party MP Javed Khan, focussed on the political implications of the delimitation process.

“We have a lingering suspicion that the SIR and the delimitation are inter-

linked. Just as the SIR was the disenfranchisement of crores of people, they want to secure the delimitation in such a way that it favours the BJP,” Mr. Brittas alleged.

‘Broader implications’
Mr. Khan argued that the BJP was jolted by the 2024 Lok Sabha results in Uttar Pradesh, where his party, SP, won as many as 37 of the 80 Lok Sabha seats, and that prompted the BJP to push for delimitation.

Mr. Ramesh argued that even now the government does not have a two-thirds majority to push through the constitutional amendment that seeks to implement the 33% reservation for women after carrying out the delimitation exercise based on the last (2011) Census. But the government has not yet prorogued the Monsoon Session as it plans to bring the

Bills around October 11, during the auspicious period of Navratri.

The Congress MP said the issue should not be framed merely as a North-South divide, as it has much broader implications.

Welcoming the distinguished panelists and guests to the event, Suresh Nambath, Editor of *The Hindu*, said the book does not frame the delimitation debate as a North-South conflict, but as an examination of democratic and federal principles.

“We are here to make sure that democracy and federalism are not seen as undermining each other, but reinforcing each other,” Mr. Nambath said.

Varghese K. George, Resident Editor (Delhi) of *The Hindu*, made a brief visual presentation on the book, underlining the consequences of delimitation.

UCC is aimed at ‘permanent polarisation’, says Congress

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Wednesday accused the Narendra Modi government of using the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) as a political instrument rather than a legal reform, alleging that the manner in which it was being pursued could keep society in a state of “permanent polarisation”.

The charge came after former Bombay High Court judge Justice R.C. Chavan resigned from the Maharashtra government’s seven-member UCC panel, citing differences over its functioning and the manner in which public feedback was being sought.

Congress communications chief Jairam Ramesh, in a statement, said Justice Chavan’s resignation raised wider questions about the pursuit of separate UCCs by States. He questioned if the Constituent Assembly envisaged every State framing its own version of UCC.

Mr. Ramesh also cited the 21st Law Commission’s 2018 Consultation Paper on Reform of Family Law, which concluded that UCC was “neither necessary nor desirable at this stage” and advocated reform within existing family laws while preserving India’s legal and cultural diversity.

Later, when asked about the statement, he said, “The UCC ‘bulldozer’ is to permanently polarise society.” Justice Chavan, in his resignation letter, objected to reducing complex social questions to “yes or no” responses, saying he had understood that the exercise was intended to elicit public views and build consensus.

Police file chargesheet naming eight in Ram Temple donation case

Mavank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Uttar Pradesh Police on Wednesday filed the chargesheet in the Ram Temple donation embezzlement case in Ayodhya before a local court. Eight accused have been named in the document which details the sequence of events and findings from an investigation into the theft of cash and donations, sources said.

“Today marks roughly 90 days in the temple embezzlement case. The chargesheet was presented before the court by the investigating officer. The chargesheet pertains to Sections 316(5), 372, 375, 162, 131A, 132 of the Preven-

tion of Corruption Act,” said Kul Shekhar Singh of the Legal Aid Defense Council, who represents the accused in the case.

The chargesheet, running into thousands of pages, delineates the management of funds collected at the Ram temple, their subsequent transfer to financial institutions, and the documentation and verification of significant charitable contributions.

The court will now examine the chargesheet and fix a date for hearing on its admissibility. Further legal action will be decided based on the facts revealed. The court records will clarify the roles of the individuals named in the report.

BJP rejigs national team, posts new in-charges for States

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) national president Nitin Nabin on Wednesday announced State in-charges and new assignments for his team of national office-bearers with vice-president Ram Madhav accorded the charge of poll-bound Uttarakhand and a promotion for Lok Sabha MP Anil Baluni as overall coordinator for

communications, including social media, TV and print media.

BJP general secretaries Vinod Tawde and Satish Poonia had already been given charge of Uttar Pradesh and Punjab, respectively, which are also going to polls early next year. Mr. Baluni’s elevation from convenor of media cell, now handed over to Ashish Usha Agrawal, to coordinator of all media is significant and could be a signal

ahead of an anticipated Cabinet reshuffle.

National general secretary Smriti Irani has been given charge of Haryana and Chhattisgarh, while Mr. Madhav will additionally take care of Tamil Nadu.

Senior BJP leader Vinay Sahasrabuddhe will be in charge of Delhi, while Jamyang Tsering Namgyal and Darshana Jardosh will be co-in-charges. Rajya Sabha MP Tarun Chugh retains responsibility for Guj-

arat, and Bajjayant Jay Panda is in-charge of Maharashtra, backed by co-in-charges Amit Malviya, Sadanand Shet Tana-wade, and Kamaljeet Sehrawat.

Harish Dwivedi is now in-charge of Bihar and Karnataka, Odisha has been assigned to D. Purandeswari, and Rajasthan to Sanjay Bhatia. Sunil Bansal, who already holds the charge of West Bengal, has additionally been made in-

charge of Telangana.

Mangal Pandey has been made in-charge of Assam, while Kanad Purkayastha has taken over Meghalaya and Anil Antony has been given dual charge of Goa and Nagaland. Bhagwat Karad continues to oversee Mizoram. Raju Bista has been named in-charge of Sikkim, George Kurian for Lakshadweep, Rajkumar Bhatia for Ladakh, and K. Surendran for Puducherry.

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR
No. : NIT/2026-27/7288-96
अनुपकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 367/2026-27
Date : 22/09/2026

निविदाखत परीखेजानाओं पर पक्कर वसूली हेतु ई-टेंडरिंग प्रक्रिया से ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

कार्य का विवरण

कार्य की कुल अनुमतिगत लागत (रु)

Selection of Bidder for Collection of User Fee on the basis of competitive bidding through e-procurement basis for the following:-
On Sikar-Jhunjhuna-Luhana BOT Road SH-08 for a period of 01 Year. UBN: RRC26275LOB00598 3864.66 Lakh
निविदा से सम्बन्धित प्रश्न में निविदा शुरू, प्रश्नोत्तर राशि, अनुमतिगत करने व खोलने की तारीख सहित सम्पूर्ण विवरण एवं संशोधन वेबसाइट: <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> तथा <http://sppp.rajasthan.nic.in> तथा <http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in/srdc> पर देखा जा सकता है।
इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने निविदा हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है।
महाविकास

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, देवघर
ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES DEOGHAR
(स्वास्थ्य एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग, भारत सरकार के अखिल भारतीय मन्त्रालय का संस्थान)
(An Institution of National Importance under Ministry of Health & Family Welfare)
भारत सरकार/Government of India
Website-www.aiimsdeoghar.edu.in

No.-AIIMS/DEO/RECT.CELL/2026-27/384
Date-14.09.2026

9th Rolling Phase 2 Medical & Nursing Faculty Recruitment Advertisement

Advt. No.- AIIMS/DEO/RECT.CELL/2026-27/377/Phase 2, Dated: 14.09.2026

Online applications are invited for the medical & Nursing faculty posts on **direct recruitment/deputation** basis in various departments at All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Deoghar, Jharkhand.
Cut-off date for receiving soft copy of application is **15.10.2026**.
For further information candidates are requested to visit the website of institute- www.aiimsdeoghar.edu.in on regular basis.

Recruitment Cell
AIIMS Deoghar

INVITATION FOR BID (IFB)
(LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)

SRM e-Tender No. T-2687/MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre-Tender (RFx No. 6000001600) (1st Call)
MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below.
"Establishment of 2X315 MVA 400/220 kV ICTs with GIS HV bays & AIS LV bays at 400/220 kV DC line from 400/220 kV STPL Sinner (MSPGCL) S/S alongwith construction of 220 kV DC line from 400/220 kV STPL Sinner (MSPGCL) S/S to 220 kV Nashik Eklahare (OCR & GCR) S/S using HPC and reinforcement of lines at 220 kV Nashik Eklahare (OCR & GCR) S/S under Nashik zone, MSETCL, Maharashtra."
Interested bidders may obtain further information available on the website <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from **22.09.2026**.
Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA – DEPARTMENT OF SPACE CONSTRUCTION & MAINTENANCE GROUP, SDSC – SHAR SRIHARIKOTA – 524124

Brief E-TENDER NOTICE

e-Tender Notice No. CMG/C/CON/268721
On behalf of President of India, Item Rate tenders are invited through e-tendering for the following works:

Brief Name of work	Est. Value (Rs)
Miscellaneous balance works (Sewer pipeline, 2 Nos. of sewage collection wells) at Visitors Complex, SDSC SHAR.	44 Lakhs

Last date for sale (Tender documents can be downloaded) up to 30/09/2026, 14:30 hrs. For eligibility criteria and other details, interested tenderers may please refer to the detailed bilingual (Hindi-English) Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) on the website <https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html> and tender free view at <https://www.tenderwizard.com/isro>
Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMG/ SDSC SHAR

BENGALURU SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT LIMITED
Office of the Deputy General Manager-1,BSWML, 1st Floor, BBMP Building, Thimmaiah Road, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 052

No: DGM-1/BSWML/TEND/23/2026-27
Date: 23.09.2026

INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER
(Only through GOK KPP Portal Only) Call-04

The Deputy General Manager-1, Bengaluru Solid Waste Management Limited on behalf of the Managing Director, BSWML, Bengaluru invites bids from eligible bidders for the Services mentioned in the table given below.

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Amount Put to Tender per annum (Rs. in Lakhs)	EMD (in Rs.)	Contract period
1	Primary Collection and Secondary Transportation of Municipal solid waste (MSW) and Street sweeping waste in Mahadevapura-2 division (Package-25) Call-04	1,865.37	Rs.1,00,000/- through e payment mode under of the following i.e., online / RTGS/ NEFT / OTC and the balance Rs.17,65,000/- by bank Guarantee/FDR issued by Nationalized/scheduled Bank	84 Months

1) Tender documents can be downloaded from KPP Portal: **23.09.2026**. 2) Last date to upload pre-bid queries in KPP Portal: **27.09.2026 before 17:30 hrs.** 3) Tender Pre Bid meeting : **28.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs.** at above mentioned office. 4) Last Date of Receipt of Tender: **05.10.2026 before 17:00 hrs.** 5) Opening of Technical Bid: **06.10.2026 after 17:30 hrs.**
More details can be downloaded from website - <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>
Sd/-
Deputy General Manager-1, BSWML

DIPR/CP/2911/AKAR/2026-27

INBRIEF



FSSAI proposes front-of-pack labelling rollout in single step

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI), the country's food regulator, on Wednesday conveyed to the Supreme Court its proposal to adopt a single-phase approach for the implementation of front-of-pack nutrition labelling (FoPL) on packaged food products indicating sugar, salt and saturated fat levels. The regulator sought a four-month period for issuing and finalising the draft regulations under the Food Safety and Standards Act (FSS Act), 2006. The affidavit said that there would be a voluntary implementation period of 365 days by food business operators (FBOs).

ED says former Chhattisgarh PSC chief took ₹45 lakh bribe

The ED has claimed that arrested former Chhattisgarh Public Service Commission (CGPSC) chairperson Taman Singh Sonwani received ₹45 lakh through an institution controlled by him in return for favouring a businessman's son and daughter-in-law in the 2021 State service examination. The money he received was shown as corporate social responsibility (CSR) funding, it said, adding that the total proceeds of crime in this case is quantified so far to the tune of ₹3.28 crore. The probe agency on Tuesday filed its first prosecution complaint before a special court in Raipur in connection with the alleged irregularities in the CGPSC examination scam during the previous Congress government. PTI

Super El Niño to add 15,800 heat deaths in India: report

Climate Impact Lab says this year's El Niño is a 'postcard from our future', bringing temperatures climate change is projected to deliver 20 years later; national rainfall deficit is at 15% below normal

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

India could see an estimated 15,800 additional heat-related deaths, give or take 1,600, between September 2026 and February 2027, as the current Super El Niño drives unusually high temperatures, according to a report made public on Wednesday by the Climate Impact Lab. The estimate is relative to average conditions during the corresponding months from 1996-2025.

Globally, the report projects 451,000 additional heat-related deaths during the first six months of the El Niño event, including 239,000 during the September 2026-February 2027 period. It projects 19,300 deaths in Indonesia; 19,400 across the Philippines, Vietnam, Thailand, and Cambodia; 13,300 in Brazil; and 66,800 across the Sahel, a 5,000-kilometre swathe of about 10 countries across Africa, including Senegal, the Gambia, and northern Nigeria.

"This report allows decision-makers to see exactly where emergency actions



Dry spell: Heat is increasing electricity demand with nearly 40% of coal-fired power plants clocking critically low fuel stocks. FILE PHOTO

can be taken now to save tens of thousands of lives in the coming months," Michael Greenstone, co-founder, Climate Impact Lab, University of Chicago, said.

The report describes the current event as a Super El Niño, an informal term generally used for exceptionally strong El Niño conditions. El Niño occurs when waters in the central and eastern tropical Pacific become unusually warm, altering atmospheric circulation and shifting rainfall and temperature patterns worldwide. Forecasts earlier this month projected a greater than 90% chance of a very strong El Niño

during the northern hemisphere autumn and winter, with eastern equatorial Pacific sea surface temperatures already more than 3°C above normal.

Its effects are already being observed in different regions. Indonesia has experienced conditions conducive to wildfires, while parts of Central America have faced drought-related agricultural impacts. "This year's El Niño is also a 'postcard from our future', bringing temperatures climate change is projected to deliver 20 years in the future. In this way, it offers a glimpse at what lies ahead without new invest-

ments in adaptation," an accompanying press statement noted.

Rainfall deficit

In India, the southwest monsoon is entering its withdrawal phase after a season marked by deficient rainfall. The national rainfall deficit stood at about 15% below normal up to September 22, 2026 with larger shortfalls in southern and eastern parts of the country.

The heat is also increasing the demand for electricity, with nearly 40% of India's coal-fired power plants reporting critically low fuel stocks amid increased power demand associated with hotter than usual weather linked to the El Niño.

The Climate Impact Lab says it applies previously estimated temperature-mortality relationships across 24,378 regions to seasonal temperature forecasts, accounting for local climate, vulnerability, and adaptive capacity. The report does not spell out the underlying numerical relationship or coefficients connecting a particular temperature increase to a number of deaths.

SC judge defends Collegium system, hits back at Centre

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Supreme Court Justice Dipankar Datta on Wednesday lashed out at critics in the Union government who claim that the Collegium system of judicial appointment is an insular mechanism of "judges appointing judges", saying the judiciary cannot always be at the receiving end of the Executive.

"The oft-repeated phrase that 'Judges appoint Judges' is a myth which people have been fed by vested interests through motivated narratives, often drawing sustenance from certain controversial decisions taken in this century in relation to appointment of judges," Justice Datta observed.

The observations were part of his separate opinion in a split verdict on the legality of a 2023 law on appointments of the Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners.

Justice Datta said sweeping generalisations that the Collegium acted as a law unto itself overlooked the detailed consultative process and the intrinsic role of the Executive, both at the Central and State levels, as well as intelligence

and other agencies in the judicial appointment process. The judge said every judicial appointment bore the imprimatur of the President.

'Piecemeal approvals'

Justice Datta turned the spotlight on the Union government's "piecemeal approvals" of recommendations made by the Supreme Court Collegium for judicial appointments.

The judge said the government has calibrated the judicial appointment system to override recommendations of the Supreme Court Collegium. Names proposed by the Collegium gather dust for years. Even recommendations for transfer of judges are not acted upon by the government in many cases.

"This court is left to wonder why, even after the judiciary has been relegated to playing second fiddle to the Executive in the matter of appointment of Judges, is there still a clamour to induct an outsider at the stage of selection? Coming as it does from the side of the Executive, the argument ill-behoves its stature and is a feeble attempt to deflect attention from its own dereliction and failure," Justice Datta said.

SC grants time to Centre over third language for Class 6

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta on Wednesday sought more time from the Supreme Court for the Union government to reach a decision on a suggestion to spare the current batch of Class 6 students from the three-language policy.

"Take your time, but see that the Class 6 students get some relief. We did not make this suggestion on a point of legality, but after considering the comfort and convenience of Class 6 students," said Justice Joy-malya Bagchi, part of a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India, addressing the law officer.

In the previous hearing, the SC had proposed the scheme should be mandatory for Class 6 only from January 1, 2027.

SC to examine BCI's power to regulate legal education

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday decided to examine the authority of the Bar Council of India (BCI) to control and regulate legal education imparted in law colleges and national universities.

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, heading a three-judge Bench, questioned how the BCI, a regulator of the legal profession, could be considered an expert on legal education when there were domain experts and legal academicians.

The Bench said the BCI could formulate general guidelines like the duration of a law course, but had no authority to dictate the nuances of legal education.

The oral observations came while issuing notice in a writ petition filed by



Girish Mittal, represented by advocates Prashant Bhushan, Cheryl D'Souza and Pranav Sachdeva, against the constitution of the Bar Council of India Trust for Promotion of Education (Legal & Professional) and Reforms in Law and For Improvement of Research and Social Training (PEARL FIRST) and the establishment of law institutions by the Trust.

Conflict of interest
Mr. Bhushan submitted the

existence of a conflict of interest arising from the continuing institutional association of BCI and the State Bar Councils, with institutions operating in the field of legal education.

He questioned the BCI's simultaneous exercise of regulatory and inspecting functions along with the establishment of the India International University of Legal Education and Research, Goa (IIULER) through the BCI-PEARL Trust.

Mr. Bhushan said 77% of the General Council of the university, which is the supreme supervisory body, were members nominated by the BCI or the BCI-PEARL Trust.

Subsequent to setting up IIULER in Goa, the same model is proposed to be set up IIULER in Andhra Pradesh, Mr. Bhushan submitted.

MoD signs ₹811 cr. deal to buy 160 glide bombs for IAF

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Ministry of Defence (MoD) signed a ₹810.79-crore contract with Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL) on Wednesday to procure 160 Satellite Smart Anti-Airfield Weapons (SAT-SAAW) and associated equipment for the IAF. The weapon is expected to enhance stand-off precision strike capability.

According to the Ministry of Defence, Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh was present when the contract was signed in New Delhi under the Buy (Indian-Indigenously Designed, Developed and Manufactured) category.

The SAT-SAAW is an air-to-ground precision-guided glide bomb designed to neutralise enemy airfields from stand-off range.

IIT Bombay forms panel to investigate student's death

Chinmay Gaikwad
MUMBAI

IIT Bombay on Wednesday set up a committee with 10 members to probe the circumstances around the death by suicide of Sahil Ravindra Wakode, age 20, a student at the institute, on September 18, 2026. The institute's Board constituted the panel.

The panel may question Professor Suryanarayana Doolla, who has been named in the case, an official said.

Prof. Doolla has been sent on leave. This was to facilitate a probe without bias, sources said.

The Mumbai Police have transferred the probe into Wakode's death to the Crime Branch. An officer of the rank of Assistant Commissioner of Police will lead the probe. Deputy Commissioner of Police



Public outcry: Vanchit Bahujan Aghadi activists stage a protest seeking a fair investigation into the death of Sahil Wakode. PTI

(Detection-I) will supervise the investigation. The case has been registered at the Powai police station.

On Monday, Mr. Doolla was removed as Dean, Administrative Affairs, following protests over Wakode's death by suicide.

Wakode was a second year B.Tech. student in the Department of Energy Science and Engineering. The police found his body

in his hostel room on the evening of September 18, 2026, hours after the institute's authorities caught him using a phone to access ChatGPT during a examination pertaining to the semester.

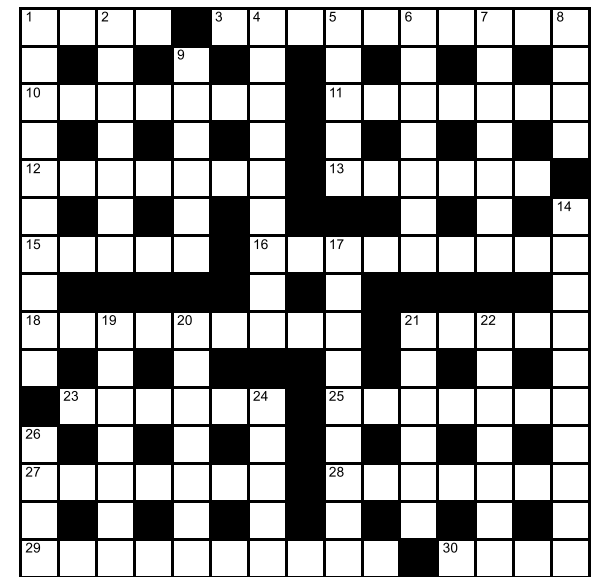
Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on the Tele-MANAS 14416, and Sneha's suicide prevention helpline 044-24640050.

THE CROSSWORD+ 14906

(set by Afterdark)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>

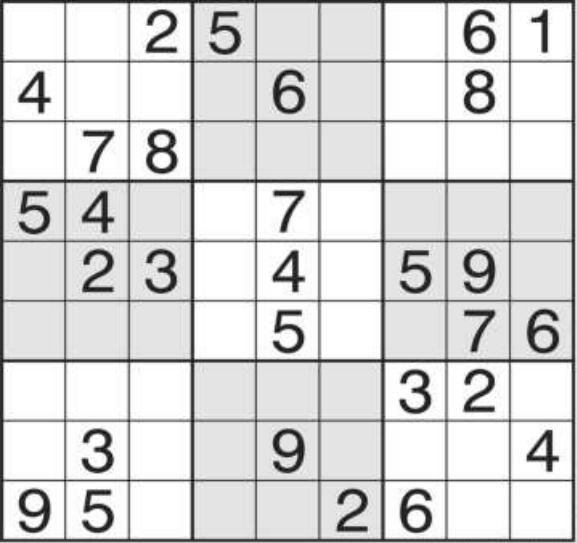
SCAN TO PLAY



- Across
- Empty bay filled with electric vehicles by company (4)
 - Part of mouse (more than one) used by learner in black arts insanely (10)
 - Spending Euros, lavishly decorate in style (3,4)
 - Where US Congress meets is Washington D.C., say, is not advanced but ordinary (7)
 - Retain port (7)

- Without resistance, say, sister could be excited (6)
- Show opener in the second half is a landlord, maybe (5)
- Agreement with criminal by faculties reportedly (9)
- Extract sugar mass from seaweed (9)
- Concluding words by messenger (5)
- Clay and soil sent back to a town near Kolkata (6)
- Infrared used in vessel, to regularly heat fish (7)
- Opposed to Turkish general in emptying Siirt (7)
- As deduced, gold ingot initially was spotted on April 1 (1,6)
- Say, massager's at large, decapitated following rule by someone from Spurge family (6,4)
- Avoid the quiet one (4)
- Say, holiday home is at Belgium, one in East Central near two hotels by a river (5,5)
- Check electronically administered by one that is experienced (7)
- Luggage holders for cars ok to fit (4,5)
- In hurricane, it's not on to go round (5)
- One having blood pressure on passage in transport (7)
- Messages to check brief lacking finish (7)
- Betrayed, hence boy is disheartened (4)
- Departed, route jammed so a diversion (6)
- Assessment at New York time by 1, Matthew is overwrought, negating in the front (10)
- Say, masthead is made of metal pane (9)
- Right hand cut in the centre by thorn of a plant (7)
- Way to cook? Criminal at hideout primarily tortures examiner (2,5)
- Mistakes by precursor; in knots after losing CPU (6)
- Painter of vehicle set out to get herbal primers (3,4)
- McDermot eternalizing hidden composition (5)
- Locks husband and innkeeper's relative at the gate (4)

SUDOKU



Solution to previous puzzle

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

FAITH

Gem of a benefactor

None can predict when it will rain, except to be sure that it will happen to alleviate distress. Perumal is also like that, none can fix a date but He will appear at the right time and make a better person of even asuras. Like rain not discriminating against anyone, He too will grant moksha to the truly repentant, said Tirukkudanthai Dr. Venkatesh.

After asura Thanjagan received Perumal's infinite grace, his two brothers, Thandakan and Gajamugan, had escaped, hiding from Neelamega Perumal and His Chakra. However, as the three brothers had harassed a number of saints, there was apprehension about what havoc the two remaining brothers would wreak on all. Sage Markandeya prayed to Perumal seeking His intervention with regard to Thandakan. Ever ready to please His devotees, Perumal, aware that Thandakan had sought refuge in the bottoms of the earth, assumed the form of Varaha, a boar. He realised Thandakan, who ran about everywhere, but soon realised that he had nowhere to hide. He fell at the feet of Perumal, who pardoned Him and offered him mukti. He then emerged in full glory, appearing like a mountain of gems, accompanied by Bhu Devi who is also known as Ambujavalli. They are worshipped as Manikundra Perumal (*mani* in Tamil refers to gem) and Ambujavalli Thayar in Thanjavur. To purchase a rare gem, one has to find a knowledgeable middleman so that one can be sure of its purity. Similarly, one should go through an acharya to find Perumal. Once that is done, one can be sure that He will always be there for the devotee. Like how a gem obeys its owner, Manikundra Perumal also heeds His devotee's shout for help whenever needed, unflinchingly.

INBRIEF



Banks to operate on Sunday ahead of proposed strike

In view of the proposed nationwide bank strike by the United Forum of Bank Unions (UFBU) from September 28 to 30, 2026, the government has announced that all public sector banks and regional rural banks will operate normally on Sunday. The UFBU, which claims to represent 90% of the banking workforce, is set to go on a three-day strike beginning September 28, primarily seeking a five-day banking week, among other demands.

India to study potential of new markets for tea exports

India is encouraging tea exports to explore new markets, as shipments to Iran are hit by the war. Amit Kumar, Joint Secretary, Union Ministry of Commerce and Industry, said on the sidelines of the UPASI annual conference in Coonoor that the Centre was focusing on markets such as Oman, which are increasing purchases of Indian tea. On increase in import of tea and concerns raised by planters, he said the focus is on increasing exports to diverse markets.

Samvridhdi can operate as online payment aggregator

Samvridhdi Inclusive Growth Network Pvt. Ltd. (SIGN), a Corporate Business Correspondent focused on last-mile financial inclusion, said that it had received in-principle authorisation from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to operate as an Online Payment Aggregator (PA-Online). Subject to final authorisation from the banking regulator, Samvridhdi Inclusive Growth Network will build and offer online payment aggregation services for merchants, it said.

Banks cautioned against ‘aggressive lending’ practices

Improving manufacturing performance and skilling the workforce would remain critical to sustaining economic growth, says Principal Secretary to the Prime Minister, P.K. Mishra

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

Principal Secretary to the Prime Minister P.K. Mishra on Wednesday cautioned banks against reviving aggressive lending practices driven by short-term optimism, warning that poor credit assessment in the past had forced the banking system to divert significant resources towards cleaning up stressed assets.

“The clean-up of the banking system required considerable resources and time. Those resources could otherwise have supported productive investment. We should therefore preserve the institutional memory of that episode,” Mr. Mishra said while addressing the SBI Banking and Economics Conclave in Mumbai.

“Credit must be appraised against the eco-



Poor credit assessment had forced the system to divert significant resources for cleaning up stressed assets, says Mishra. FILE PHOTO

nomics of the project rather than the enthusiasm of the moment. That is the surest protection against a repetition of the cycle of excessive lending, stressed assets and subsequent cleanup,” he added.

The remarks come at a time when India's banking sector has emerged from one of its worst asset quality crises, with gross non-performing assets (GNPA) at a multi-decadal low. The GNPA ratio of the banking

system fell below 1% in the first quarter of fiscal 2027, compared with nearly double-digit levels about a decade ago during the peak of the bad loan crisis.

The earlier deterioration in asset quality had contributed to the “twin balance sheet problem”, where stressed corporate borrowers and weakened bank balance sheets constrained fresh investment. The government responded through bank recapitali-

sation, consolidation of weaker lenders and regulatory measures aimed at strengthening risk management practices.

Mr. Mishra's comments assume significance as banks are currently witnessing strong liquidity conditions and improved balance sheets, raising concerns that renewed credit growth could lead to excessive risk-taking if lending decisions are influenced by market optimism rather than fundamentals.

Highlighting the need to improve India's macroeconomic resilience, Mr. Mishra stressed the importance of reducing dependence on imports and strengthening domestic manufacturing capabilities.

“We have a significant merchandise trade deficit. We must make things at home and competitively,” he said.

OECD forecasts India growth at 7.1% in '26-27

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) has become the latest global body to raise its growth forecast for India in the last week, predicting that India's economy will grow by 7.1% in 2026-27, up from

6.3% forecast in June.

This comes soon after the three most-recognised global ratings agencies – Moody's, S&P Global, and Fitch Ratings – raised their respective growth outlooks for India over the last week. The OECD, in its Economic Outlook Interim Report September 2026 released on Wednesday, said

that several countries have been able to mitigate the damage from the West Asia crisis by rapid growth in artificial intelligence-related investment and production in many economies.

For India, however, it said domestic demand and government policy cushioned the impact.

“This was also the case

in China, whilst growth in several other G20 emerging market economies, such as India, Indonesia and Brazil, was underpinned by resilient domestic demand and government policies that cushioned households and firms from the impact of higher energy prices,” the report said.

‘Indian OMCs incur ₹530-cr. daily losses’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Indian oil market companies (OMCs) are estimated to be incurring under-recoveries of ₹8 per litre on petrol, ₹9 per litre on diesel sales and almost ₹300 per domestic LPG (liquefied petroleum gas) cylinders, according to credit rating agency ICRA.

The combined impact translates into an estimated daily loss of about ₹530 crore from the sale of pe-

trol, diesel and cooking gas for the OMCs, ICRA analysts said.

“The escalation of the conflict in West Asia and the [resulting] disruption to key oil supply routes has led to a sharp increase in crude oil prices, which has also resulted in sizeable marketing and LPG under-recoveries for oil marketing companies,” said Prashant Vashisht, senior vice-president and co-group head of corporate sector ratings at ICRA.

BRICS must work in sync on transfer-pricing disputes: FM

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman urged BRICS nations to share experiences on treaty interpretation and multilateral negotiations in international taxation, saying global transfer pricing disputes “disproportionately” burden developing countries.

India proposed to set up two new working groups, International Taxation and Transfer Pricing and Reve-

nue Statistics at a time when global tax rules are being renegotiated, she said at BRICS heads of tax authorities meeting here.

Multilateral tax issues

“There are several multilateral tax issues, including the UN Framework Convention on International Tax Cooperation, under active talks. The decisions made at these processes over the next few years will shape cross-border taxation for a generation.

Transfer pricing refers to pricing of goods and services exchanged between related firms. International transfer pricing disputes arise mainly as countries seek to ensure MNCs are subject to tax on profits attributable to their respective jurisdictions. Accordingly, differences in allocation of taxable income among countries can give rise to disputes among taxpayers and tax authorities as well as those in different jurisdictions.

HC rejects CBI plea on ex-NSE chief bail

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court on Wednesday, dismissed the CBI's challenge to the bail granted to former NSE MD and CEO Chitra Ramkrishna in the NSE employees' illegal phone tapping case.

Justice Madhu Jain rejected the agency's plea against the trial court's December 22, 2022 order granting the bail.

The CBI, in its FIR, said senior NSE officials, includ-

LG, Samsung face tariff evasion probe over OLED TV parts

Reuters
NEW DELHI

India is investigating LG Electronics and Samsung for allegedly paying lower tariffs on imported display parts of high-end TVs, five sources told Reuters, putting under scrutiny the premium entertainment devices both South Korean giants have bet big on.

Lengthy import tariff and tax investigations have been a sore point for foreign investors in India and embroiled companies like Samsung and Volkswagen, though Indian officials say they are simply enforcing the law of the land.

The latest investigation concerns imports of display parts that go into making panels for OLEDs, or organic light emitting diode technology, which offer superior picture quality and are made by LG Electronics and Samsung in India, a key growth market for them.

The market for pricey OLEDs is still niche globally, however, with just 6.5 million units sold last year, research firm Omdia says. Counterpoint Research data shows India's TV market was worth \$4.7 billion last year, with OLEDs having a near 4% share.

Indian officials have alleged the companies wrongly claimed a concessional 5% tariff on imported OLED glass screens called open cells, arguing the rate has for years been reserved for the older LCD and LEDs which dominate mass-market sales, said the sources, who declined to



The DRI believes Samsung and LG should have paid a 15% duty for OLED parts.

be identified as the matter is confidential.

For OLED parts, India's Directorate of Revenue Intelligence believes Samsung and LG should have paid a 15% duty, said two of the sources aware of the investigation.

The companies are privately opposing the position of Indian authorities as they believe OLED is nothing but an advanced form of LED technology and the same Indian tariffs should apply, the sources added.

The sources did not comment on the financial details of the amount of duty allegedly underpaid. Typically, following an investigation, authorities can issue tax demand notices and impose penalties of up to 100% of the duty evaded. Companies can legally challenge such demands in courts. Samsung said in a statement to Reuters that it is “reviewing the matter and cooperating fully with the relevant authorities, adding it is firmly committed to complying with all laws.” LG and the revenue directorate did not respond to queries.

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

Capital flows are increasingly blurring the lines between financial markets, raising the risk of shocks spreading from one segment to another, thus calling for closer coordination among regulators, Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) Chairperson Tuhin Kanta Pandey said.

He said traditional boundaries separating banks, capital markets, insurers etc. were turning less distinct.

NANAJI DESHMUKH VETERINARY SCIENCE UNIVERSITY
JABALPUR (MADHYA PRADESH)

No. 3531/ /NDVSU/2026 Date: 22/09/2026

NOTICE FOR SPOT COUNSELING (OFFLINE)
FOR ADMISSION IN B.V.Sc. & A.H. / B.F.Sc.: 2026-27

Spot Counseling (Offline) for admission in remaining vacant seats (free and payment) of B.V.Sc. & A.H. and B.F.Sc. degree programmes 2026-27 will be held as under:

Degree programme	Date	Qualifying examinations	Venue	Time
B.V.Sc. & A.H. (5.5 years)	30.09.2026	NEET (UG) 2026	Auditorium, Veterinary College, South Civil Lines, Jabalpur (M.P.)	09.30 a.m.
B.F.Sc. (4 years)	30.09.2026	NEET (UG) 2026/ CUET 2026		

For details, rules and vacant seats visit University website: www.ndvsu.org / <https://ndvsu.mponline.gov.in>

Registrar

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER,
EASTERN CIRCLE-I, CANTONMENT ROAD, KATAKA.

Email id :- seecuttack@gmail.com

“e” Procurement Notice No.ACE, EC-I/09 of 2026-27

1. Nature of work : Stone work, Road work & Canal Lining Work
2. Total no. of works : 3 Nos.
3. Tender Amount : Varies from Rs.335.62 Lakh to Rs.590.90 lakh (Approx.)
4. Tender paper cost : Rs.10,000/- per each tender (Non refundable)
5. EMD required : As mentioned in Section No.1 of DTGN (Clause No.6)
6. Class of contractor : As mentioned in Section No.1 of DTGN (Clause No.1)
7. Period of completion : As mentioned in Section No.1 of DTGN (Clause No.8)
8. Online for bidding : 30.09.2026 at 10.00 hrs. to 14.10.2026 up to 17.30 hrs.
9. Date & time of opening of Tender (Technical bid) : 15.10.2026 at 11.30 hrs.

Other terms and conditions can be seen from the Govt. website “www.tendersodisha.gov.in”.

All corrigendum / cancellation of tender if any, will only be uploaded in the above web site.

Additional Chief Engineer, Eastern Circle-I, Kataka.

32001/915/2627 OIPR-32001/32379/1/26-27/0008

NANAJI DESHMUKH VETERINARY SCIENCE UNIVERSITY, JABALPUR (M.P.)

2nd Counselling and Admission Notice for 2026-27

Applications are invited for admission in Bachelor of Veterinary Science & Animal Husbandry (B.V.Sc. & A.H.) and Bachelor of Fishery Science (B.F.Sc.) degree courses for the session 2026-27 under following quota seats:

1. Non Resident Indian (NRI) seats
2. Foreign national category seats
3. For wards of Kashmiri Migrants and Kashmiri Pandits/Kashmiri Hindu Families (Non-migrants) living in Kashmir valley
4. For students from Union Territories of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh

For details visit University website www.ndvsu.org The date for submission of application and physical presence is **29th September, 2026**

No. 3532/2026 Date: 22/09/2026

Registrar

KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD
(DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE, GOVT. OF KERALA)

Head Office : Thycaud, Thiruvananthapuram-14,
(Telephone No. 0471-2945600, 2945646)

E-mail : edrugs.kmscl@kerala.gov.in,
website : www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616

No.KMSCL/ED/25/2026 Date : 22.09.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are invited from manufacturers/loan licensees on behalf of Department of Health, Govt of Kerala for the Procurement of Risdipnam Oral Solution for the year 2026-27.

Sl. No.	Tender No. and Date	No. of Item
1.	KMSCL/ED/RISDIPLAM/RC/2026/023 dtd: 22.09.2026	1

Schedule of dates

Particulars	Date	Time
Last date of online uploading of tenders	29.09.2026	05.00 pm.
Date of technical bid opening	01.10.2026	11.00 am. onwards

Tenders shall be downloaded and submitted online through the e-tender portal www.etenders.kerala.gov.in.

(Sd/-) MANAGING DIRECTOR (Tender Inviting Authority)

OFFICE OF THE MUNICIPAL COUNCIL, BHADRAK

Tel.No. 06784-251519(O), Fax No. 06784-251221

Email:- bhadrakm.hud@od.gov.in & eobdkmunicipality@gmail.com

Letter No:- 5193 Date:- 21.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

On behalf of the Bhadrak Municipal Council, Executive Officer of Municipality invites Request for Proposal (RFP) from interested agencies who fulfil the eligibility criteria requirement set forth in the RFP document for “**Establishment Request For Proposal (RFP) For Development Of 60 TPD Capacity Municipal Waste To Charcoal Plant With Operation & Maintenance For 25 Years (Extendable Up To 5 Years) On PPP Basis (DBFO) At- Bhadrak Municipality.**” The detail RFP document can be seen and downloaded from website <https://www.bhadrakmunicipality.nic.in> & <https://bhadrak.odisha.gov.in> from 25.09.2026 (11.00 AM) onwards.

1. Schedule of Events:

Period of availability of Tender Document in website	From Dt., 25/09/2026 to Dt.22/10/2026 (till 5:00 PM)
Pre-bid meeting (Physical)	On Dt. 06/10/2026 (Time 12.30 PM) (Office of Executive Officer, Bhadrak Municipality, Bhadrak
Last date and time of receiving queries to be sent to email id: eobdkmunicipality@gmail.com (Format as Per RFP)	Dt. 09/10/2026 (by 5:00 PM)
Last date and time for submission of bids	22/10/2026 (till 5:00 PM)
Date and time for technical bid opening	23/10/2026 (11:00 AM)
Financial bid Opening	Will be Communicated by Bhadrak Municipality
Address for submission of Bid	The Executive Officer, Bhadrak Municipality, Bhadrak - 756001. Email: eobdkmunicipality@gmail.com

2. All amendments, Clarifications, time extension etc. will be uploaded in the website only interested parties should regularly visit the above website to keep themselves updated.

Executive Officer, Bhadrak Municipality

13001/1931/2627 OIPR-13001/13152/1/26-27/0007

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - e-Procurement Notice
OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, CENTRAL MINOR IRRIGATION CIRCLE, BHUBANESWAR

Phone-0674-2540559; Mail ID: cmic.bbsr@gmail.com; No.1714 /CMIC Date : 21.09.2026

The Additional Chief Engineer, Central Minor Irrigation Circle, Bhubaneswar on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites **percentage rate bids in Double cover only in ONLINE mode** for the works detailed in the table from “**B” & “A” class** Contractors registered with the State Government and contractors of equivalent Grade/ Class registered with Central Government/M.E.S./Railways for execution of civil works on production of definite proof from the appropriate authority. The bidders may submit bids for any or all of the works.

e-Procurement Notice-BID IDENTIFICATION NO- ACE - CMIC -2/2026-27

1	Name of the works	“Improvement to Head Works of Gayapathara M.I.P (Res) in Bapur Block of Nayagada District under DPW scheme for the year 2026-27
2	Total No. of works	1 (One) no
3	Estimated Cost	Rs 190.11 lakh Approximately (Detail list of work Annexed)
4	Class of Contractor	Class “B” & “A”
5	Period of completion	As Mentioned against Work.
6	Date & time of Availability of Bid Document in the portal for online bidding.	28.09.2026 at 10.00 AM to 13.10.2026 up to 5.30 P.M.
7	Last date/Time for receipt of Bid only in ONLINE	13.10.2026 up to 5.30 P.M.
8	Date/Time of Opening of Technical Bid,	14.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M. at Office of the Addl. C.E Central M.I Circle, Bhubaneswar through Web site
9	Date/Time of Opening of Financial Bid	To be intimated online after offline evaluation of Technical Bids.
10	Date of Transparent Lottery (If cases arises)	To be intimated through mail after offline evaluation of Financial Bids.
11	Name & Address of the Officer Inviting the Bid.	Additional Chief Engineer, Central M.I. Circle, Bhubaneswar, Plot No.-A-3/2, Po: Bhojnagar, Bhubaneswar PIN: 751022. Dist: Khurda. Ph:9674-2540559
12	Mode of Payment of Bid Cost	Online

Further details can be seen from the “e”-procurement portal : <https://tendersodisha.gov.in>

Additional Chief Engineer, Central M.I.Circle, Bhubaneswar.

32001/913/2627 OIPR-32001/32047/1/26-27/0003

Making a point: One of the participants speaking at the session on 'Refinery to Energy Hub'. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

CM
YK

Refinery sector must balance energy security with net-zero push: experts

‘Meaningful partnerships bring tangible outcomes’



Industry leaders urge Tamil Nadu govt. to incentivise green buildings

"An additional free FSI would be great. If such a programme is run for say a decade, it would easily become the standard," they added.

‘Start-ups require support from ideation stage to drive energy transition’

The session was moderated by Sangeetha Kandasavel, Senior Assistant Editor, *The Hindu*.

Indian sailor killed in attack on vessel in Hormuz, say authorities



Russia voices interest in 'limited ceasefire', says Rubio after talks



Harvey Weinstein sentenced to 15 years for New York sexual assault



Houthi to target U.S. interests if it supports Saudi-led strikes: adviser



‘We are not terrorists, but victims of terror’: Iran’s Pezeshkian at UN

Associated Press
UNITED NATIONS

"We have only defended ourselves. We are not ter-



He added of the United States: "Yes they did hit us, but we did not bend the knee." Toward the end of

Arriving in New York under heavy security and scrutiny, Mr. Pezeshkian — who, within Iran's political landscape, is considered a moderate politician — addressed world leaders a day after Mr. Trump used the same stage to suggest he may “annihilate” the Is-

"Ladies and gentlemen, you all bore witness that this past June, my country was subjected to a savage aggression and flagrant contravention of the most elementary principles of international law," Mr. Pezeshkian said at the time.

With Trump-Xi truce, China looks to reshape Asian order

Ananth Krishnan
BEIJING

as tariffs, restrictions on semiconductors and Chinese export controls, especially on rare earths. China is also pressing the U.S. to

The broader reason for a continued truce, in the view of Da Wei, was the narrowing power differential between the two coun-

“This is consistent with the principle of ‘Asian solutions to Asian problems’,” he said. “Confronted with an increasingly complex regional security landscape, we must fend off external interference, seek common ground while reserving differences, proactively manage divergences and facilitate peaceful settlement of disputes.”

First U.S.-Iran shuttle talks in months raise hopes for progress

Reuters
UNITED NATIONS/DUBAI

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi and U.S. envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner communicated through mediators on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly in New

“Steve and Jared had a very productive meeting today with mediators of

Pak. shoots down 8 drones 'launched from Afghanistan'

Press Trust of India
ISLAMABAD

Four drones were brought down near the Torkham border and another four in mountain-

Afghanistan denied Pakistan's claim, with the Taliban regime rejecting allegations that Afghan Taliban forces had attacked Pakistani positions.

Sport

Kushagra gets his century before Mulani runs through Australia-A

Abhishek Saini
PUDUCHERRY

Sangha produced a 64-ball 46 (5x4, 1x6) after walking in at 37 for three, and a late recovery appeared to be the theme for the second day in a row. He began with consecutive sweep shots off Mulani (four for 67) after tea before riding the bounce

Liam Scott took a leaf out of this playbook and ransacked 14 runs off Tanush Kotian in three deliveries. However, Scott was

Sam Konstas was far from the hot-headed opening renegade, who had caught India by surprise during the last Border-Gavaskar Trophy. He put a price on his wicket and negotiated the early period. But Deshpande's delivery

The scores: India-A 334 in 117.3 overs (Sai Sudharsan 57, Kumar Kushagra 113, Tanush Kotian 69, Keshav Rocchiccioli 4/95) vs. Australia-A 171 in 55.3 overs (Jason Sangha 46, Shams Mulani 4/67).

Lakshya stars as India u-19 complete sweep

Shayan Acharya
RAJKOT

Chasing 255, India started briskly, with Aaryavir and Lakshya taking on an



V.K. Vineeth failed to get going, but Lakshya kept the chase moving. Even after Kushagra's dis-

Flat deck
Opting to bat on a flat deck, Australia made a strong start as Zed Hollick (87, 88b, 12x4) and Neel Patel (51, 71b, 1x4) added 62

The scores: Australia u-19 254 in 49.3 overs (Zed Hollick 87, Neel Patel 51, Blake Cattle 38, Mohit Ulva 3/43, Manal Chauhan 3/42) *lost to* India u-19 255/4 in 41.2 overs (Lakshya Raichandani n.o. 110, Aaryavir Sehwaag 34, Kushagra Ojha 45, Rajat Baghel n.o., 44).

SURREAL

This time I have fulfilled my Asian Games dream: Mirabai



PTI

I have dreamt of winning an Asian Games medal ever since I stepped into weightlifting. Something or the other happened before or during the Games, but this time I have fulfilled my dream. I am yet to decide on how to go about LA 2028. I will enjoy this medal for a while and then decide — Mirabai Chanu after winning silver.

BREAKING THROUGH

Jay Meena wins India's first-ever medal in soft tennis at Asiad



X@SAI

Jay Meena won India's first-ever soft tennis medal at the Asian Games, fetching a bronze after losing to Takuya Kurosaka in the men's singles semifinals. Taking part in his third Asiad, the 26-year-old produced a spirited fightback before losing 2-4 (3-5, 1-4, 1-4, 4-1, 6-4, 1-4) to the Japanese in a 45-minute clash.

NO SWEAT

Deepika scores nine as India women thrash Thailand



AHF

In-form drag-flicker Deepika Sehrawat extended her impressive run, scoring a record nine goals, as India thrashed Thailand 20-1 to register its third consecutive victory in Pool B of the Asian Games women's hockey competition in Kakamigahara on Wednesday. India, which is leading the group, will next play Japan on Friday.

GOLD IN SIGHT

Roshibina prevails over Thania, enters wushu summit clash



PTI

Indian wushu player Roshibina Devi, in red, will fight for gold at the Asian Games after defeating Indonesia's Thania Kusumaningtyas in the women's 60kg category in Nagoya on Wednesday. Roshibina, who prevailed 2-0 in the last-four contest at the Aichi Prefectural Martial Arts Hall, will face China's Xiaoyu Zhang in the summit clash.

Mirabai lifts silver, ends long wait for Asian Games medal

A total of 198kg helps the icon finish behind North Korea's Gum, who completes a hat-trick of titles with a World record 215kg effort; dream finally turns into reality for the 32-year-old Indian

ASIAN GAMES

Jonathan Selvaraj
NAGOYA

Mirabai Chanu's place in the pantheon of Indian sporting greats was already secure. Olympic silver, World championship gold and multiple Commonwealth Games golds had ensured that.

So, just how much could an Asian Games medal matter? It turns out that it mattered to her for close to a decade and a half.

"I was thinking that I've won medals at the Olympics, World championships and Asian championships. Why can't I just win a medal at the Asian Games? I've been trying since 2014 but wasn't able to," said Mirabai after the final of the 49kg category.

North Korea's Ri Song Gum was in a class of her own. She won her third consecutive Asian Games gold and broke her own



Weight off her shoulders: Mirabai beams with joy and pride after winning a medal at the Asian Games for the first time in her illustrious career. AP

World record with a total of 215kg. The precocious Vijayana Diana, just 21, edged ahead of Mirabai after snatch, lifting 88kg to the Indian's 87kg. But in

clean and jerk, Mirabai's strength made the difference. She had 107kg and 111kg while the Indonesian's best was 103kg. Mirabai's total of 198kg was

enough for silver; she didn't even need a final attempt. It was the medal she had chased for eternity. The obsession finally become reality.

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

The Aichi General Shooting Range continued to reward Indian shooters with medals at the Asian Games here on Wednesday, just not the colour they desperately want; or the events that they expected to win in. The men's and women's skeet teams both finished third for a bronze while two of the three shooters in the final — Anantjeet Singh Naruka and Raiza Dhillon — fell agonisingly short, finishing fourth. Parinaaz Dhalwal finished eighth in the individual event as India's wait for a shooting gold continues.

The shotgun arena made up for the disaster inside the firing range where Esha Singh and Suruchi Phogat had forgettable outings in the qualifying and failed to make the cut for the final while Manu Bhaker bowed out fifth in the 10m air pistol, an event the three of them have been dominating.

Naruka, the silver medalist from Hangzhou, missed two of his first four shots and despite trying his best, was unable to overturn the deficit.

In a field where the smallest of margins meant



Fruitful outing: The men's team of Mairaj, Naruka and Bhavtegh and the women's trio of Raiza, Maheshwari and Parinaaz made it to the podium. R.V. MOORTHY

survival or elimination, it was not so much Naruka misfiring as his competitors not faltering. He scored 25 out of 28 shots, one behind bronze medalist Lee Meng-Yuan of Taiwan. Among the women, Raiza ended with 23 out of 28 while Parinaaz was the first to be eliminated.

Earlier, the men — Mairaj Ahmed Khan and Bhavtegh Gill along with Naruka — totalled 346 over three days of qualifying rounds to finish behind Qatar (353) and Kuwait (348).

The women's trio of Raiza, Parinaaz and Maheshwari Chauhan totalled 331 in the qualifying to finish

third behind China (357) and Kazakhstan (336) for the first-ever Asian Games medal in women's skeet.

"It's a great feeling knowing that [we are the first] but I think the girls were in great form and I am hoping we will go with a few more medals, a little disappointed it not being a better colour," Maheshwari said. "The reason [for shotgun taking a backseat] is because we just didn't have high performing athletes and enough female athletes to begin with."

In pistol, Manu finished her qualifying round with 579 in third position. Esha began with series of 94 and 93 before picking up pace but a 95 and 96 in the last four series was never going to be enough, as she finished with 572 points with 12x. Suruchi, meanwhile, had three series of 94 each and one of 93 for a total of 568 with 12x to finish 26th.

In the final, Manu never really got going, starting with a 9.9 and ending with a 9.6 and just two 10.8s throughout her series of 18 shots. The biggest setback was an 8.9 on her eighth shot, which pushed her down into elimination zone and although she kept surviving, it was a matter of evading the inevitable.

'Feels like life is complete'

Jonathan Selvaraj
NAGOYA

Asian athletes have dominated the women's 48kg and 49kg weight divisions for 25 years, winning 27 of 30 Olympic medals and holding all World records. And so, the desperation for an Asian Games medal is understandable for India's Mirabai Chanu.

"I'm feeling so happy... so light. *Bilkul weight hat gaya hai* (the weight has lifted completely)," she said after the win.

In the Hangzhou Asiad of 2023, Mirabai knew she had tweaked her hip during warm-up, but she gritted her teeth and loaded 117kg on the bar — the second-most she had ever attempted — as she bid for bronze.

However, she collapsed and had to be carried off stage. Previously, she'd fal-



Winning smile: Mirabai added another silver to her collection. AP

len short in Incheon 2014 and missed the 2018 Jakarta edition with injury.

When the lightest Olympic weight division moved to 53kg, Mirabai — rather than bulking up for the LA Games after missing out at Paris — kept her weight down to focus on the podi-

um in Nagoya.

"I had to work so hard to preserve myself to maintain my weight but this was so important for me."

With a silver medal in hand now, she exclaimed, "It feels *ki life complete ho gaya* (It feels like life is complete)," she said.



Tough going: Manu felt really sorry for not being able to win a medal in the 10m air pistol event. R.V. MOORTHY

Manu shooting through tears and challenges

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Manu Bhaker has had a rough two years since the Paris Olympics high, both on and off the range. The 24-year-old has had a couple of podium finishes in both 10m and 25m pistol each, a far cry from her own high standards, but it's the sudden death of coach, mentor and father-figure Jaspal Rana earlier this year that really broke her.

The Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games is her first competitive outing since Rana's passing and, expectedly, it wasn't easy for the youngster. Talking to the media after her fifth-place finish in the 10m air pistol, Manu began bravely, talking about the match before a mention of Rana finally broke open the shell.

"Of course I miss him, he was the best of the best, the Asian champion. When it came to Asian Games, I think he was the undisputed champion and we were really looking forward to

Japan," she started before getting overwhelmed. Eyes welling up, unable to speak, she walked away, the floodgates finally making way for a torrent of tears gushing down her face.

It took a few minutes but she returned and her composure and decision to complete the interaction was perhaps the biggest hat-tip to Rana, ever the professional.

Talk about shooting and Wednesday's performance brought back a semblance of normality. "I genuinely tried my best and I really feel the performance was significantly better than the challenges I have been facing in my training in Japan. I feel really sorry I was not able to make it to the podium, I hope I will be able to do better," she said.

The training challenges she mentioned included sunlight affecting her focus during the pre-event training and inability to see the sides but she insisted that she was focused on the process.

THE INDIA SHOW

A look at some Indian performances on Wednesday:

Badminton: Men's team (semifinal): lost to China 1-3, bagged bronze.

Boxing: Men's 80kg (round-of-16): Ankush bt Hamsa (Brn).

Fencing: Table-of-16: Men's sabre individual: Gisho lost to Sarkissyan (Kaz) 11-15; Table-of-32: Men's sabre individual: Karan lost to Luo (Chn) 14-15; Women's foil individual: Ashitha lost to Gnoyeva (Kaz) 14-15; Mina lost to Jihee (Kor) 3-15.

Hockey: Women (Pool B): bt Thailand 20-1.

Kabaddi: Women (Group A): bt Iran 37-23; Men (Group A): bt Bangladesh 48-25.

Shooting: Finals: Women: 10m air pistol individual: Manu (fifth); Team: Fourth (Manu, Esha, Suruchi); Skeet individual: Raiza (fourth), Parinaaz (eighth); Team: Bronze (Raiza, Parinaaz, Maheshwari); Men: Skeet individual: Anantjeet (fourth); Team: Bronze (Anantjeet, Mairaj, Bhavtegh).

Soft tennis: Men (semifinal): Jay lost to Kurosaka (Jpn) 2-4, clinched bronze.

Squash: Round-of-32: Men: Abhay bt Arkarahirunya (Tha) 3-0; Veer bt Wakeel (SL) 3-0; Women: Tanvi bt Dami (Kor) 3-0.

Swimming: Men: 100m butterfly: Benedicton (13th overall), DNQ for final; 200m freestyle: Aneesh (17th overall) and Vedaant (19th overall), DNQ for final.

Table tennis: Mixed doubles (round-of-16): Harmeet & Yashaswini bt To & Lam (Hkg) 3-1; Manush & Diya bt Moosa & Aishath (Mdv) 3-0.

Weightlifting: Women: Final: 49kg: Mirabai (silver); 53kg: Gyaneshwari (eighth).

Wushu: Women's 60kg sanda semifinal: Roshibina bt Thania (Ina).



Falling short: While Satwik and Chirag did their job in doubles, the others faltered. REUTERS

Indian men shuttlers finish with a bronze after loss to China

Press Trust of India
NAGOYA

Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty won their doubles match but Lakshya Sen and Ayush Shetty faltered against higher-ranked opponents as the Indian men's team signed off with a bronze medal after losing 1-3 to China in the Asian Games semifinals here on Wednesday.

India had won silver at the last edition in Hangzhou, where it had lost to China in the final.

World No. 14 Lakshya, who had produced a stirring performance to take India to the semifinals, could not quite bring his A game, going down 16-21, 18-21 to world No. 6 Shi Yu Qi in the first singles.

Satwiksairaj and Chirag then produced a sensational performance to outwit

reigning world champions Liang Wei Keng and Wang Chang 21-11, 22-20 to bring India back into the five-match tie.

A lot rode on young Ayush, but the world No. 20 could not maintain the required discipline and lost 19-21, 13-21 to world No. 12 Li Shi Feng in the second singles.

The responsibility to keep India afloat then fell on Hariharan Amsakarunan and M.R. Arjun, who took on the scratch pair of He Ji Ting and Liu Yi in the second doubles but they lost 16-21, 21-17, 9-21.

The results (semifinals): China 3 bt India 1 (Shi Yu Qi bt Lakshya Sen 21-16, 21-18; Liang Wei Keng & Wang Chang lost to Satwiksairaj Rankireddy & Chirag Shetty 11-21, 20-22; Li Shi Feng bt Ayush Shetty 21-19, 21-13; He Ji Ting & Liu Yi bt Hariharan Amsakarunan & M.R. Arjun 21-16, 17-21, 21-9).



INTERVIEW

K. Keerthivasan

CM
YK

SCIENCE

As AI marches on math research, scholars ponder the future

A flurry of AI-generated proofs has left mathematicians in various emotional states; some are cautiously excited, some are critical of the AI companies' commercial motives behind their relentless mining of open maths problems and are insisting on more careful regulation, and some are left asking existential questions

Rohini Subrahmanyam
BENGALURU

On July 20, mathematician Levent Alpöge, who works at the artificial intelligence company Anthropic, dropped a casual post on X. He claimed the company's advanced large language model Claude Fable 5 had produced a counterexample to an 87-year-old open problem in algebraic geometry called the Jacobian conjecture. By working on it during the FIFA World Cup final, AI had helped disprove a conjecture that many mathematicians had been working on for decades – and the world got the news about it in a short social media post.

This was not AI's first major mathematical conquest. On May 20, OpenAI released a series of posts on X claiming that its internal, general reasoning model had found a solution to the planar unit distance problem, an open problem proposed by Hungarian mathematician Paul Erdős in 1946. Many expert mathematicians who verified the solution realised that if humans had solved this on their own, the result would be out in a top journal.

The floodgates were opened. On August 1, OpenAI announced that its newest model 'Astra' had solved ten more open maths problems, three of which were from the legendary list of Erdős problems that included the unit distance conjecture. AI had been solving other less exciting Erdős problems and International Math Olympiad questions even before tackling the unit distance problem – but this latest set had many people sit up and take notice. As Columbia University theoretical computer scientist Henry Yuen posted, "I did not just hear about these problems from my friends or from seminars. I feel their importance in my bones; I deeply care about the answers to these questions."

In the most significant advance yet, on September 8, OpenAI announced that an unreleased internal model had solved a Millennium Prize Problem called the Navier-Stokes existence and smoothness problem – one of six heavily researched maths problems with a million-dollar bounty.

Spurred by rumours that their rival Anthropic might be closing in on a solution, OpenAI went all guns blazing, deploying 10,000 autonomous AI agents and millions of dollars' worth of computing power and found a solution in 88 hours.

But even as it rattles the maths world, the achievement is already shrouded in controversy. On September 7, New York University mathematician Tristan Buckmaster revealed he and Mr. Alpöge had been personally building on previous work by other mathematicians and working on a solution for a simplified version of the problem using similar methods for about a year, and they were assisted by both Anthropic and OpenAI models in their efforts.

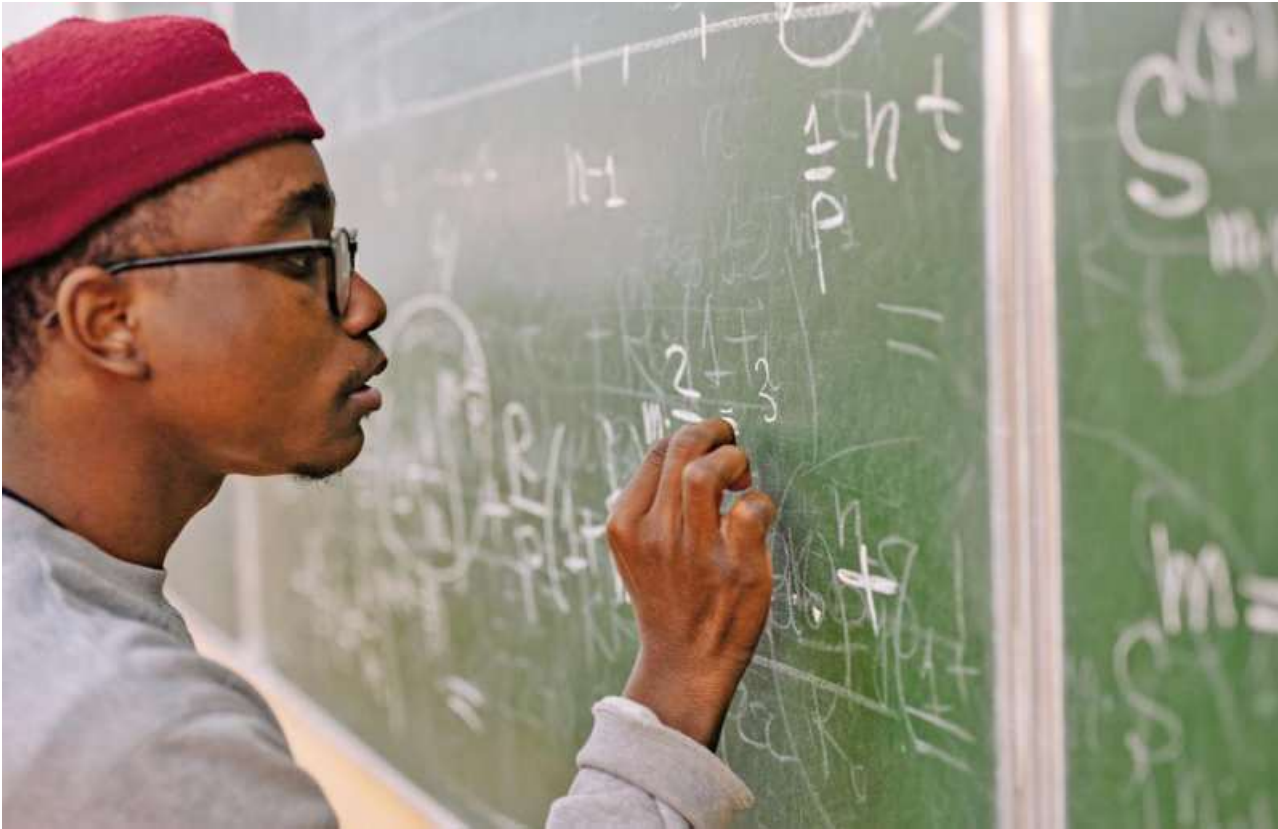
While OpenAI has denied specifically accessing the duo's data, the company noted "they cannot rule out that de-identified data from [the duo's] usage of their products helped improve their models."

This flurry of AI-generated proofs has left mathematicians in various emotional states. Some are cautiously excited about how the fast-improving models can help them in their research. Some are critical of the AI companies' commercial motives behind their relentless mining of open maths problems and are insisting on more careful regulation. And some are left asking existential questions: if AI can solve important problems at this alarming rate, what role will mathematicians play in the future?

The rise of AI has generated an unprecedented level of discourse and introspection among mathematicians about what they really value and enjoy about doing maths, with one sentiment prevailing among them. As MIT mathematician Andrew Sutherland put it: "I think it is going to change the way mathematicians do research going forward."

Andrew Booker, a number theorist in the University of Bristol, had been stuck solving a central problem in number theory with a collaborator for about ten years. Called the converse problem for L-functions, they would work on it for a few weeks, give up out of frustration, and periodically return to it. "And suddenly, that all changed in April," he said.

Dr. Sutherland had gifted Dr. Booker



AI models operating at the level of a grad student have made thinking, which is usually difficult, much cheaper. Representative image. YAN KRUKAU/UNSPLASH

a gift subscription to Claude Max, finally pushing him to use Claude Code, which is Claude's AI coding agent, on the problem. He was not expecting much – but the AI model wrote 30,000 lines of code and about 200 pages of maths in the first week, "an amount I would write in a year," he said. Although they have not completely solved the problem yet, "within two weeks we had made more progress than in the previous five years."

The frontier AI models released in the last year have become a lot better at reasoning compared to the older, more sycophantic versions. "It works almost eerily like a human," said Dr. Booker. "It reasons things out in the same way. It makes the same mistakes as a human." It needs expert guidance in the hard problems, but it can, on occasion, find something very obvious that humans completely missed.

"They are not perfect, but they are operating at the level of a grad student, with the difference that they are a hundred times faster than grad students," Dr. Booker said. "It is like having a grad student army, if you like."

That feels powerful because it has made thinking, which is usually difficult, much cheaper. Humans might have several ideas but cannot work on all of it to the same extent the way AI can. "And if it continues improving [at this] pace, it will not be long before it matches the skill set of the best mathematicians in the world," Dr. Booker said.

Dr. Sutherland got interested in using machine learning and AI in mathematics research in early 2022, before the large language models era. As a computational number theorist, he realised that AI/ML tools could help find interesting patterns in large amounts of data. Researchers slowly realised that the models were like a "more intelligent search engine", he said, being able to sift through literature and find useful connections between vastly different fields of maths.

But a major turning point for him was when Claude's Opus 4.5 came out late last year, which is an AI agent that can code, produce proofs, and formalise them – i.e. convert them to a computer science-based language (like Lean), which can be verified by a machine. In the last six months or so, the newest AI tools are "both good at writing code and very good at math, and that combination has been very, very valuable," Dr. Sutherland said. "I am still the one driving the process, but having these tools lets me go faster and see further than I could before. It is an exciting time from that perspective."

'It writes like an alien'
Nevertheless, he understands why these powerful AI tools can be disconcerting, especially for theoretically inclined mathematicians who enjoy solving very hard, complicated problems. Instead of thinking deeply about a problem for many years, one can now get an answer from a model immediately with a few well-placed prompts, he said.

Some maths students are worried about whether they will have jobs in the future, and whether mathematicians will become obsolete if AI models become better than them at

Recent frontier AI models have become a lot better at reasoning compared to older versions; while they need expert guidance in hard problems, they can, on occasion, find something very obvious that humans completely missed

solving problems. One of the winners of the 2026 Fields Medal, Jacob Tsimerman, has stopped taking graduate students on because he is uncertain about whether the traditional mathematical career he trains them for now will even exist in a few years. (He has since moved to OpenAI to work on AI safety).

AI's proofs are not perfect, however. The models tend to gloss over the hard parts of the proof, Dr. Sutherland said – which is usually the key, intuitive step that humans may struggle with and ultimately gain insight from if they tackled it on their own. Also, models' proofs are incredibly hard for humans to understand: as it rapidly borrows concepts and vocabulary from vastly different mathematical fields and learns on the go, it tends to make up weird terminology as it's working. It also does not cite all the previous research it is building on.

"It writes like an alien sometimes," Dr. Booker said. "If left unchecked for too long, you may be left with text that is completely incomprehensible. It is [not] meaningless gibberish – the AI understands it – but it is so far removed from standard terminology that I can no longer parse it."

Dr. Booker eventually learnt that he must supervise the AI assistant to keep it grounded, prune its long arguments, and rewrite some of its proofs to add more intuition, to keep it less dry and more appealing to human readers. Researchers have called OpenAI's proof write-ups "horrendous" on X, implying that the companies are not communicating their results in a way that others can gain insights from them.

There is, however, an unsettling way to circumvent mathematicians entirely: AI can rapidly generate and formalise its own long, incomprehensible proofs, which can then be machine-verified.

In an essay titled 'Mathematics in the Age of AI', the Australian-American mathematician and 2006 Fields Medal winner Terence Tao discussed how the field could shift from "proof scarcity to proof abundance", and with more proofs than humans can deal with, this may also end up in

"proof indigestion". "Something that is happening with these large language models releasing these proofs one after another is we have not had time to chew and understand these proofs," Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, Mumbai, computer scientist Prahladh Harsha said. A nightmare situation, Columbia University mathematician Michael Harris said, is that AI will generate a long, incomprehensible proof of the Reimann hypothesis – one of the most famous open problems in mathematics – and humans will just have to accept it without understanding it.

"It is a very confusing time right at this moment, because nobody knows what the rules are," said Dr. Booker. Many mathematicians are worried that the AI tools are developing at a rate faster than human institutions can adapt.

Dr. Sutherland, however, does not think mathematicians will become obsolete. There is still value in humans being able to understand the proof on their own, to learn not just "what is true but why it is true," he said. With infinitely many mathematical problems and only a finite number of computers, he does not think that mathematics will be "solved" by AI. But with AI trivialising the easier problems, "the bar to make a significant contribution is going to rise," Dr. Booker said.

Students may need to be trained differently, as "maybe pure, problem-solving ability is not going to be as highly valued in the future as it was in the past," Dr. Sutherland added. Improving the exposition of AI-generated proofs or using AI assistance to tackle and understand hard problems may become more important. But people passionate and excited about maths should still pursue it, he said, willing to work with students who engage with AI tools in their research. Current students' careers may look very different from their own advisers', he noted, but that does not mean they will not have one.

'Generous with ideas'

After a 2025 conference titled 'Mechanization and Mathematical Research' at Leiden University, a small group of the participants stayed in touch and drafted a set of much-needed guidelines for responsible AI use. They came to be called the 'Leiden Declaration on Artificial Intelligence and Mathematics'. With many distinguished endorsers, including Dr. Tao, the June 2026 declaration has emerged as an important step in understanding how AI tools affect mathematics, with recommendations on how to engage ethically with them. Dr. Harris and University of California San Diego mathematician Karthik Ganapathy, two members of the working group involved in drafting the declaration, are both critical of how AI companies do not release a detailed account of how exactly their internal models have solved a problem – in most cases, the result is declared as a press release or

as an unceremonious social media post. "The best mathematicians are very generous with their ideas," Dr. Ganapathy said, unlike giant AI corporations that are incentivised to not be open about their methods. This lack of transparency also makes it hard to ascertain how much the advanced mathematicians working at AI companies played a role in the proof.

Harvard University mathematician Nina Zubrilina agreed that the companies should ideally be releasing the prompts they used in the discovery process to get more insight into the model's reasoning. "There is a certain amount of intentional mysticism around how they arrive at certain results, which I find counterproductive for understanding something deeper," she said.

Ideally, these solutions should lead to a deeper theory or "set the groundwork for something bigger." Simply resolving a decades-old conjecture "is not really the right metric for success," she added. "It makes for good headlines, but it is not necessarily what is valued kind of the most for people who do mathematics for a living," she said, while also noting that AI might improve at theory-building in the future.

Maths as cultural capital

Although he may use AI for routine work, Dr. Ganapathy wants to think on his own to preserve the pleasure of doing pure maths. "It is not like we want to completely offload all aspects of [doing mathematics] to a machine," he said, saying how no mathematician is "asking OpenAI to build a model which can reason this way." Pure maths problems might eventually lead to applications only if humans are able to think together and apply the insights they learn in innovative ways, and AI using opaque methods to produce impenetrable proofs will hinder this process.

"Corporations have no material interest in abstract mathematical research," said Dr. Harris, who thinks there are two reasons driving the AI companies: they think rigorous mathematical reasoning may bring the models closer to artificial general intelligence – a vague, hypothetical intelligence that will match and/or beat humans in all cognitive tasks; and demonstrable mathematical prowess may make investors happy. Academics' "goals are trying to understand the math [and] science behind these [proofs], but [the companies'] goals are to show that they have built very smart models and monetise that," Dr. Harsha said.

Also, not everyone can access the frontier AI models: students in India do not have access to them the way U.S. students do, Dr. Harsha said. On July 29, OpenAI announced that it will allow 1,00,000 scientists, mathematicians, and engineers to access its frontier models for free – but Indian, Russian, and Chinese institutes were excluded from this list, most likely because of geopolitical tensions.

India, with no frontier model of its own, unlike the U.S. or China, might struggle to keep pace with theoretical scientific advances at this rate, even though the large country had previously enjoyed an edge over others in the theoretical sciences. "Mathematics is certainly one way that [AI companies are] trying to gain cultural capital, which will inevitably help them change policy," said Dr. Ganapathy.

Dr. Harris thinks that instead of treating AI as an inevitable natural phenomenon, mathematicians must recognise it as a product of giant, commercially driven corporations. Are they then comfortable with these corporations dictating the direction of mathematical research?

"The interests of mathematics are protected by mathematicians and not by the corporations," Dr. Harris said. "As long as the mathematicians are free from external interference or attempts to shift the funding strategies in the direction more beneficial to the investors, I think they can be trusted to use the AI technology in a way that is in general interest."

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For feedback and suggestions for 'Science', please write to **science@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Daily page'

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Cost of Chandni Chowk's Town Hall redevelopment

225 in ₹ cr. Redevelopment proposal for the Town Hall situated in Delhi's Chandni Chowk has been initiated with an estimate cost of ₹225 crore. An MoU was signed between the Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi. PTI

Daily fuel losses faced by oil firms as crude prices surge

530 in ₹ crore. Indian Oil Corporation, Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd are losing ₹8 a litre on petrol and ₹9 on diesel, while under-recoveries on LPG stand at about ₹300 a cylinder. The daily loss to OMCs is estimated at ₹530 crore. PTI

Percentage growth recorded by retail sector in August

10 in per cent. India's retail sector maintained a steady trajectory in August, recording a 10% year-on-year pan-India growth, according to a survey. Building on July's recovery, stable consumer demand across regions and categories indicates strong industry preparation for the festive peak. PTI

Decline in seafood export value from Odisha to West Asia

14.5 in per cent. The export value of fish, shrimp and other seafood items from Odisha to the West Asia region declined by 14.57% in 2025-26, resulting in a loss of approximately ₹23.40 crore, Minister Gokulananda Mallik said on Wednesday. PTI

Percentage hike in DA for employees notified by Punjab govt.

8 in per cent. The Punjab government notified an 8% increase in dearness allowance for government employees and pensioners. This reflects the government's commitment towards the financial well-being of its employees and pensioners, a statement said. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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How are road accident claims decided?

Who can file a motor accident claim? Who is liable to pay? When can an insurer be directed to pay and recover? Who can claim compensation for a deceased person? What are the four heads of compensation in a death case?

EXPLAINER

Kartikey Singh
Barkha Dwivedi

The story so far:

India has the world's largest road network, spanning about 6.7 million kilometres, larger than the U.S.'s 6.59 million km and China's 5.49 million km, but it also records the world's highest road fatalities. Over-speeding and reckless driving, poor road upkeep, inadequate driver training, and weak emergency and trauma care continue to make road crashes a severe public-safety crisis.

According to the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways' *Road Accidents in India 2024* report, 4,87,707 road accidents in 2024 claimed 1,77,175 lives (about 485 deaths a day or 20 an hour) and injured 4,71,441 people. With road crashes estimated to cost around 3.14% of India's GDP, their impact extends beyond lost economic productivity, falling most heavily on dependants of those killed or permanently disabled. Yet, for many claimants, courts' quantification and compensation awards remain difficult to navigate.

What is the legal framework?

The Motor Vehicles Act, 1988 (MV Act) is the principal law governing motor-accident compensation. The MV Act creates a statutory scheme covering the entire accident chain, from regulation and driver and owner duties to insurance, liability, investigation, and compensation. For adjudicating claims, Section 165 empowers State governments to constitute Motor Accidents Claims Tribunals (MACTs) for specified areas to determine claims arising from motor-vehicle accidents.

Under Section 166, a claim may be filed by the injured person, the owner of damaged property, or, in case of death, by all or any of the deceased's legal representatives (LRs). The insurer, owner, and driver are ordinarily parties to the proceedings, as the Tribunal must determine both the amount of compensation and the party liable to pay it. The claim is ordinarily first heard by the MACT, which is the primary fact-finding and compensation-awarding forum. An appeal under Section 173 may be filed before the High Court within 90 days, subject to the depositing of ₹25,000 or 50% of the awarded amount, whichever is less. In determining liability, the Tribunal typically examines the FIR and chargesheet, site plan, Mechanical Inspection Report, post-mortem report or medical/disability records, insurance policy, and the depositions of eyewitnesses and the investigating officer, etc.

Importantly, the same accident may generate two distinct proceedings: a criminal case for offences such as rash or negligent driving, and a separate MACT claim for compensation. As held by the apex court in *Reena v. Managing Director, KSRTC* (2026), an acquittal in the criminal case does not affect the MACT proceedings, since the two operate in distinct legal spheres and apply different "standards of proof".

Who is liable to pay the compensation?

Liability initially attaches to the negligent driver and, vicariously, to the owner of the offending vehicle. Where the vehicle is insured, the insurer generally satisfies the award. Section 146 mandates compulsory third-party insurance, while Section 150 requires insurers to satisfy awards arising from third-party risks,

The compensation formula

The Supreme Court's framework breaks down compensation into four heads before the final amount is calculated

Step	Head of compensation	Formula	Result
1	Loss of dependency (Loss of income)	[(Annual income + future prospects) – deduction]] × multiplier	(A)
2	Loss of estate	Flat conventional figure (base: ₹15,000; currently after 10% increase per 3 year: ₹18,150/-)	(B)
3	Funeral expenses	Flat conventional figure (base: ₹15,000; currently after 10% increase per 3 year: ₹18,150/-)	(C)
4	Loss of consortium (spousal/parental/filial)	Flat conventional figure (base: ₹40,000; currently after 10% increase per 3 year: ₹48,400/-) × Number of claimants entitled to consortium	(D)
TOTAL COMPENSATION			(A) + (B) + (C) + (D)

Prepared as per the framework laid down by the Supreme Court in Sarla Verma (2009) and Pranay Sethi (2017)



Under Section 166, a claim may be filed by the injured person, the owner of damaged property, or, in case of death, by any of the deceased's legal representatives

subject to limited defences under Section 150(2), including specified policy breaches, unauthorised use, driving without a valid licence, and non-disclosure or misrepresentation in obtaining the policy. Even where a defence is established, courts may apply the "pay and recover" principle, directing the insurer to pay the victim/LRs first and recover the amount from the owner or driver thereafter.

A separate "no-fault liability" route dispenses with proof of negligence and provides compensation of ₹5 lakh for death and ₹2.5 lakh for grievous hurt (post the 2019 amendment), payable by the owner or authorised insurer, without proof of negligence.

How to calculate compensation in accidental deaths?

Money cannot substitute for a life lost, but motor-accident compensation seeks to ease the financial burden on the deceased's dependants. Section 168 of the MV Act requires an award of "just" compensation. Through landmark decisions such as *Sarla Verma* (2009) and *Pranay Sethi* (2017), the top court has evolved standardised formulas and foundational principles for giving effect to this requirement. Once "rash and negligent" driving is established, the quantum can broadly be understood as a three-stage exercise: first, establishing the foundational facts; second, applying them to the prescribed heads and formulae; and third, aggregating the amounts to arrive at the final award.

The first stage is to establish three facts: (1) the deceased's age at the time of the accident, (2) annual income and (3) number of dependants. "Age" can be established, among others, from the date of birth recorded in the school-leaving certificate and not from the Aadhaar card, as was ruled in *Saroj* (2024) by the Supreme Court. "Income" means actual income less income tax paid (as per *Pranay Sethi*). The Supreme Court in *Rashmirekha Tripathy* (2026) held that, for salaried persons, the ITR of the immediately preceding assessment year should ordinarily be considered, while for self-employed persons or business owners, the Tribunal should take the average income reflected in the preceding three years' ITRs, subject to the circumstances. Where income cannot be proved, the applicable State-notified minimum wage for the relevant time for unskilled, semi-skilled or skilled category is used. The LRs, including married and earning sons and daughters, are entitled to claim compensation, regardless of financial dependency on the deceased, as settled by the Supreme Court in *Jitender Kumar* (2025).

The second stage is to translate these three facts into the four heads under which compensation in a death case is computed: (A) loss of income/dependency, (B) loss of estate, (C) funeral expenses, and (D) loss of consortium. The major component is "loss of income", which represents the financial loss suffered by the dependants on account of the victim's death. For the first head, the calculation begins with the deceased's "annual income" to which the prescribed percentage towards "future prospects", having regard to the deceased's age and nature of employment, is added. From the resulting figure, the prescribed "deduction" towards the deceased's personal expenses

is made, and the balance is multiplied by the appropriate "multiplier" to arrive at the "loss of income". The aforesaid three components perform different functions: "future prospects" account for the career growth the deceased would reasonably have received had they survived. As delineated in para 61 of *Pranay Sethi* (2017), for a person in a permanent government or salaried job with assured career progression, 50% is added where the deceased was below 40 years, 30% where aged 40-50 years, and 15% where aged 50-60 years; no addition is made above 60 years. For a self-employed person or one on a fixed salary, the corresponding additions are 40%, 25% and 10% for these three age groups, respectively, with no addition above 60 years.

Further, the "deduction" recognises that a portion of the deceased's earnings would have been spent on their own personal living expenses. As per *Sarla Verma* (2009), for a married deceased with two to three dependent family members, the standard deduction is one-third (33%); where there are four to six, it is one-fourth (25%); and where there are seven or more, it is one-fifth (20%). In the case of a bachelor or unmarried deceased, the usual deduction is one-half (50%) where the parents or other dependants are the claimants, although courts may reduce the deduction where the number of dependants is particularly large. Lastly, the "multiplier" represents the deceased's remaining active working life and is determined solely with reference to age. According to *Sarla Verma*, the multiplier is 18 for ages 15-20 and 21-25; 17 for 26-30; 16 for 31-35; 15 for 36-40; 14 for 41-45; 13 for 46-50; 11 for 51-55; 9 for 56-60; 7 for 61-65; and 5 for 66-70 years.

The remaining three are conventional heads and, unlike "loss of income", do not depend on the deceased's profession or actual earnings. Under *Pranay Sethi* (2017), (i) "loss of estate" was fixed at ₹15,000, representing the loss of savings, investments and accumulated assets that the deceased could reasonably have built up and left for the heirs; (ii) "funeral expenses" at ₹15,000; and (iii) "loss of consortium" at ₹40,000 for each eligible family member, recognising the emotional trauma and loss of companionship, love, care and guidance. Consortium includes spousal consortium for the surviving spouse, parental consortium for surviving children, and filial consortium for parents who lose a child. Each eligible family member is independently entitled to the standard base amount, and therefore the applicable consortium amount is multiplied by the number of eligible dependants.

These three conventional amounts are to be enhanced by 10% every three years, as directed by the Supreme Court in *Pranay Sethi* (para 61).

The third stage is simply to aggregate the four heads to arrive at the compensation payable. Additionally, the court may also grant interest under Section 171, typically ranging between 6% and 9%, depending on the facts of the case.

In a significant judgment recently, in *Shishu Pal* (2026), a case involving the accidental death of a homemaker, recognising that household work, including cooking, cleaning and caregiving, supports the paid workforce, the Supreme Court fixed a minimum notional income of ₹30,000 per month under a new head of "loss of domestic care", with a 10% cumulative enhancement every three years. (*Kartikey Singh and Barkha Dwivedi, lawyers based in New Delhi*)

THE GIST

The Motor Vehicles Act, 1988 provides the legal framework for motor accident claims, with MACTs determining compensation and liability, while insurers generally satisfy awards subject to statutory defences

For fatal accidents, compensation is calculated using the deceased's age, income and number of dependants, with future prospects, personal-expense deductions and an age-based multiplier applied to determine loss of income

Courts also award compensation under conventional heads such as loss of estate, funeral expenses and consortium, with interest where applicable; a recent ruling has also recognised loss of domestic care for homemakers

The word “ornamental” also means decorative, but unlike “ornate” it isn’t associated with anything negative. When you say that something is “ornamental,” what you are implying is that the object has been designed to be decorative without being too vulgar or ostentatious. The stress in this word is on the third syllable, “men”.
Published in The Hindu on January 29, 2002